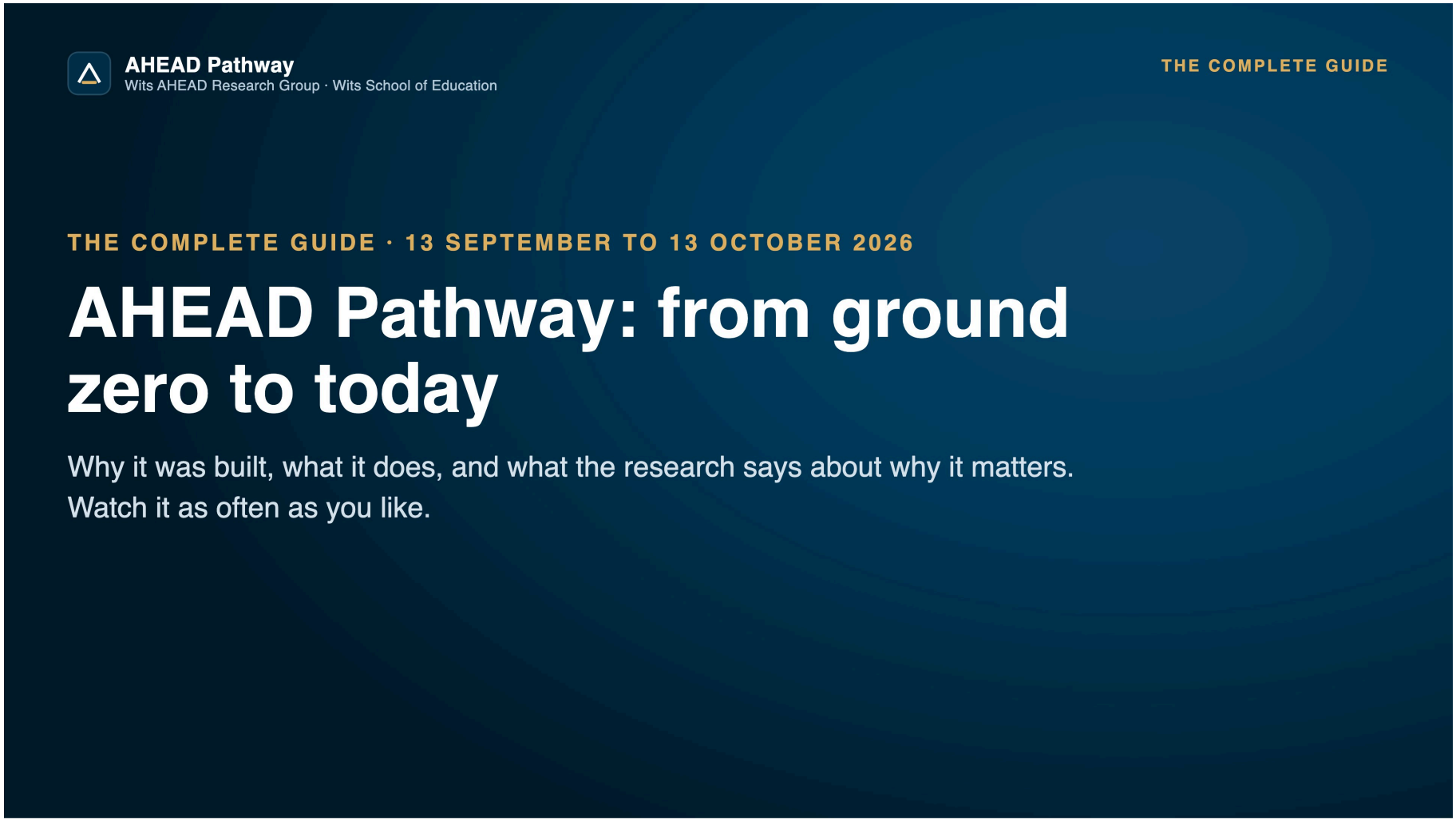
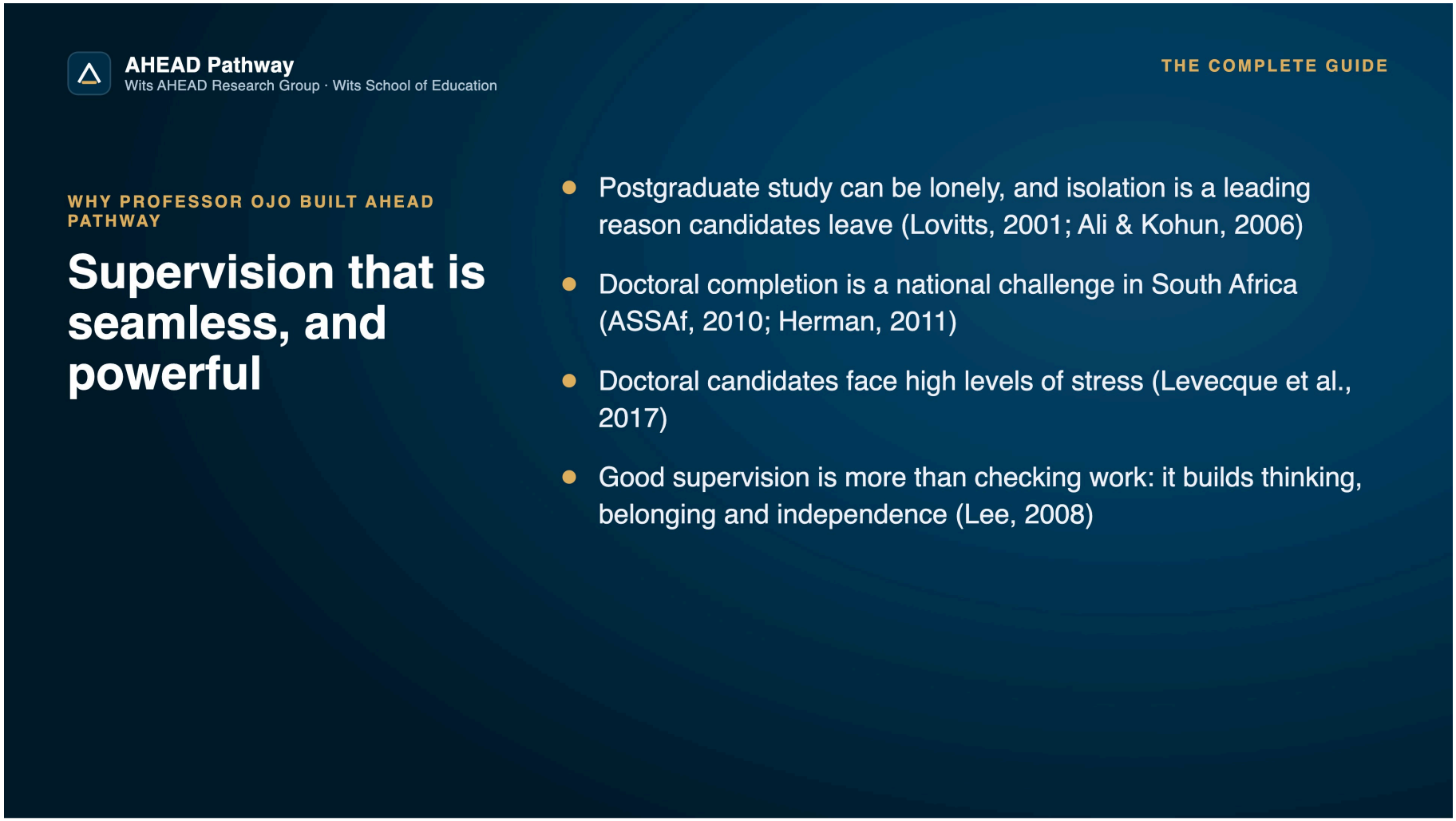
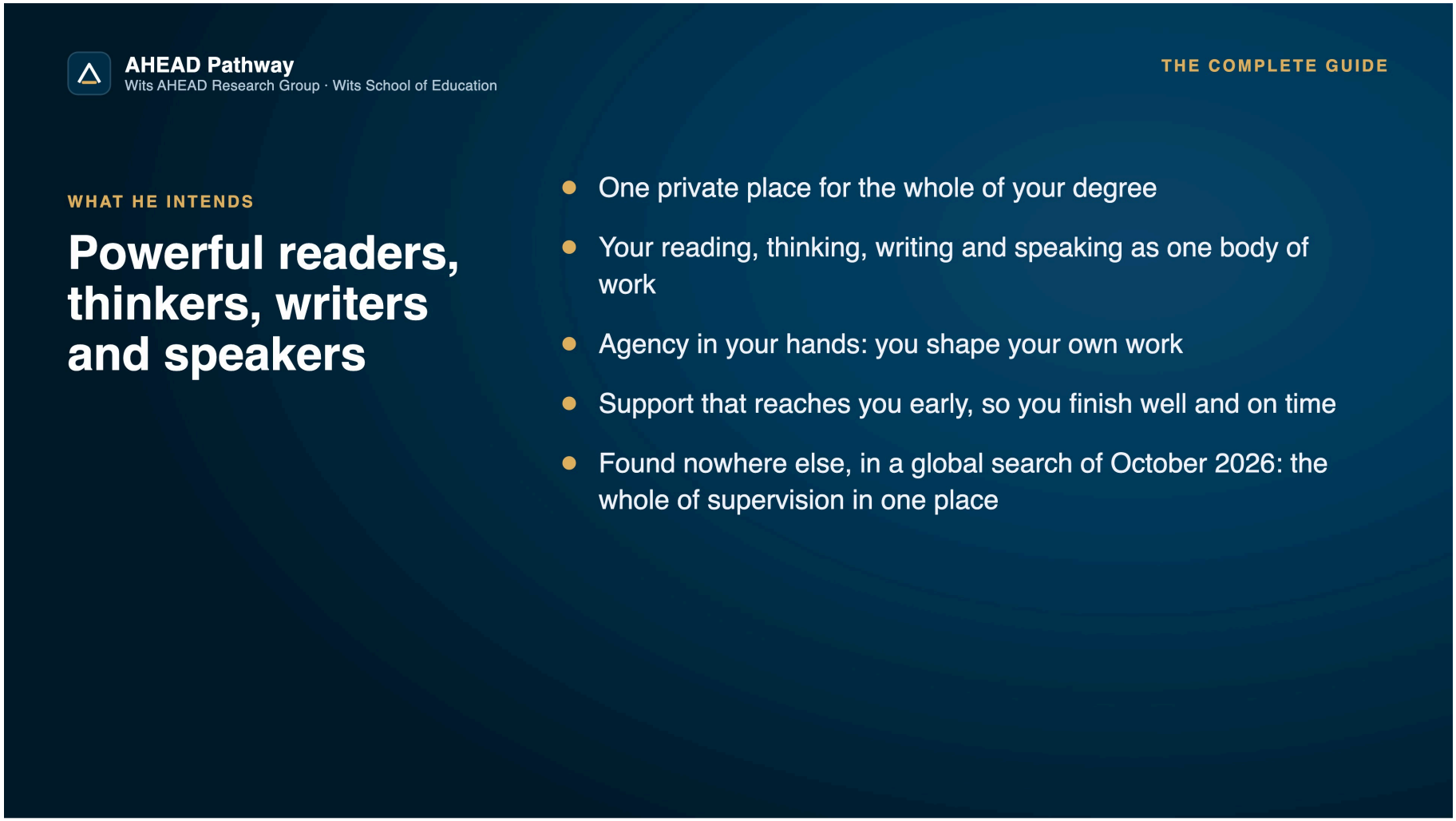


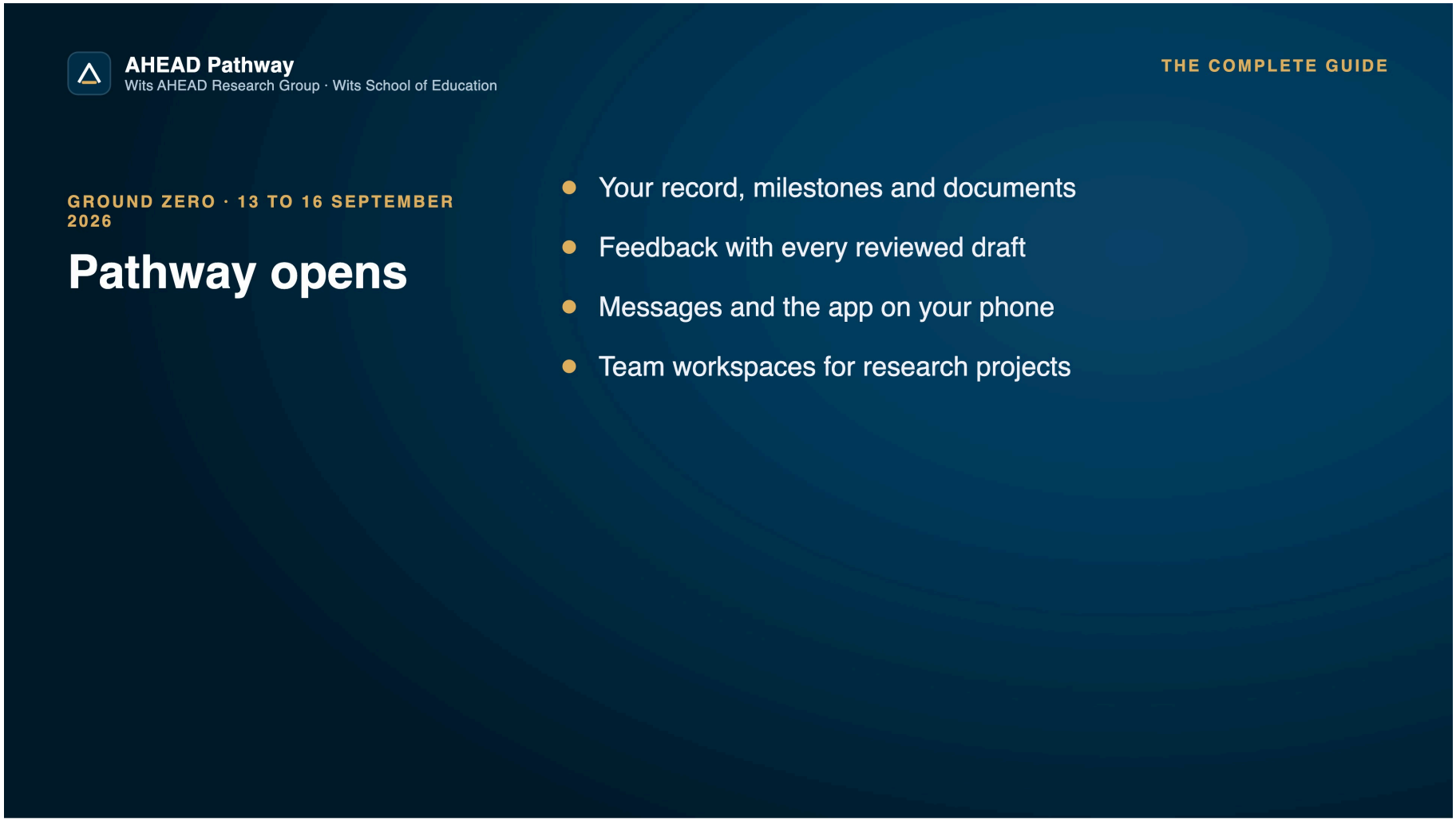
> **How to use this guide.** This is the written companion to the narrated video. Read it alongside the video, or on its own; every slide is here with the words you hear. Come back to it as often as you like: each time, try one more part of AHEAD Pathway.



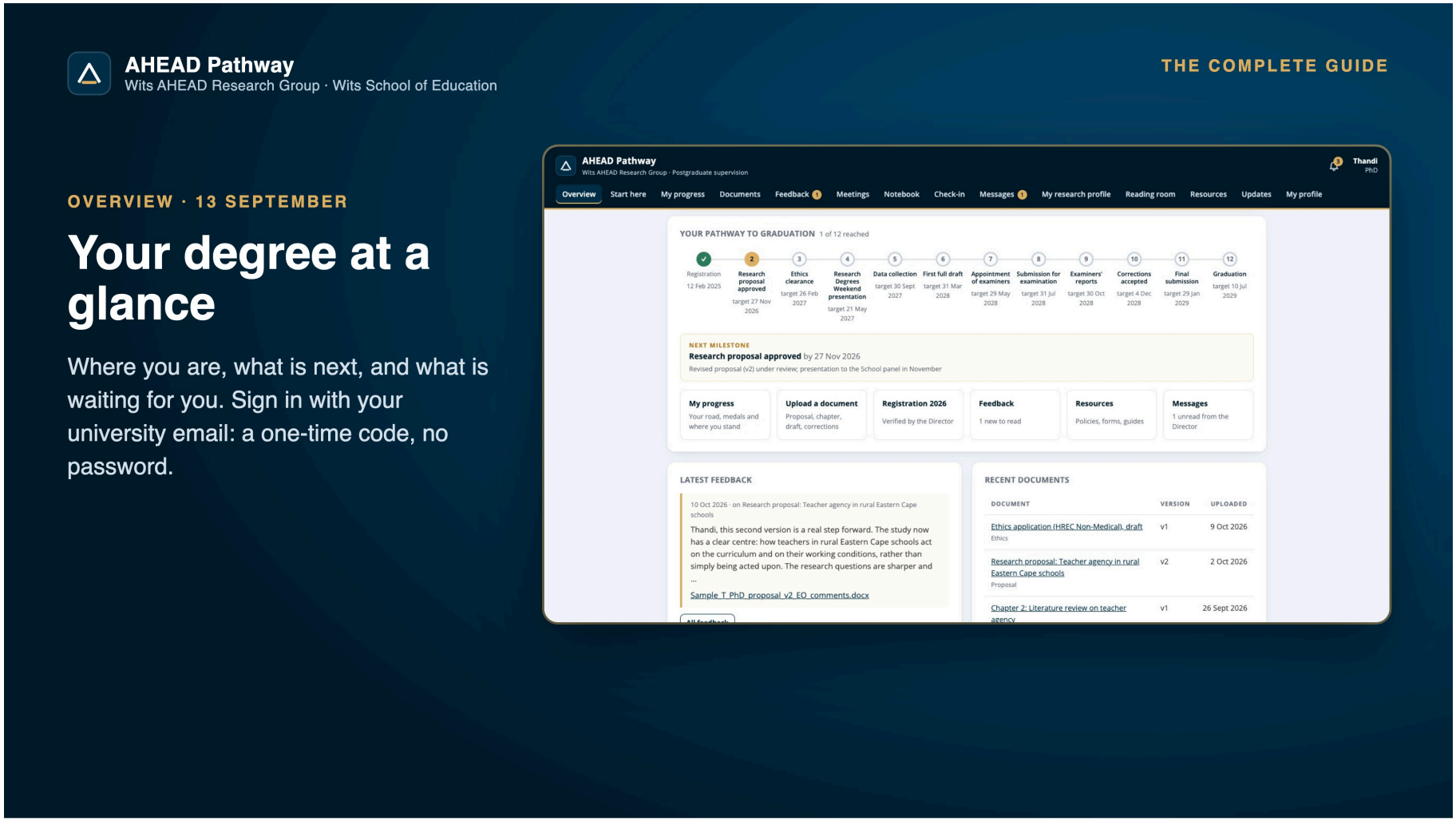
2 OF 33 Why did Professor Emmanuel Ojo build AHEAD Pathway? Because the research is clear. Postgraduate study can be lonely, and isolation is one of the main reasons candidates leave their degrees, as Lovitts, and Ali and Kohun, have shown. In South Africa, completing a doctorate on time is a national challenge, as the Academy of Science of South Africa and Herman have documented. Doctoral candidates face high levels of stress, as Levecque and colleagues found. And Anne Lee's work shows that good supervision is far more than checking drafts: it builds critical thinking, belonging in the discipline, and independence.



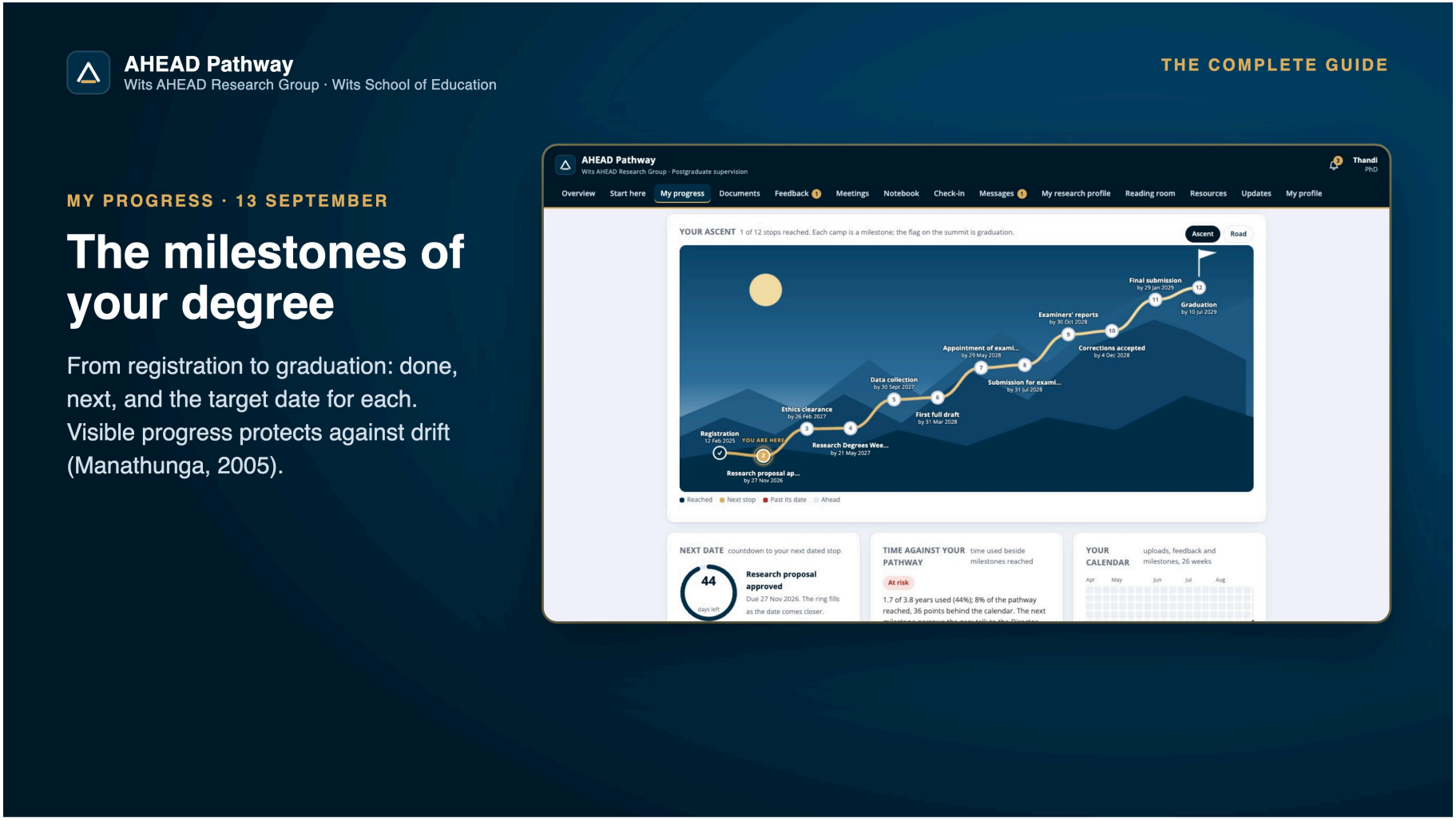
3 OF 33 So Professor Ojo set out to bring the whole of supervision into one living place, built around you. His intention is that every one of his postgraduate students becomes a powerful reader, a powerful thinker, a powerful writer and a confident speaker, and that working this way becomes second nature. Your reading, your thinking, your writing and your speaking come together as one body of work. The agency is in your hands. And support reaches you early, so that you finish well, and on time. Reviews of online doctoral supervision around the world find that candidates patch together separate tools, mostly for communication, as Gray and Crosta, and Lee and colleagues, have shown. We have searched widely and found no other platform, anywhere, that brings the whole of postgraduate supervision together in one place as AHEAD Pathway does: your record, your conversations and calls, your readings and evidence map, and a practice panel that has read your own work and your supervisor's feedback.



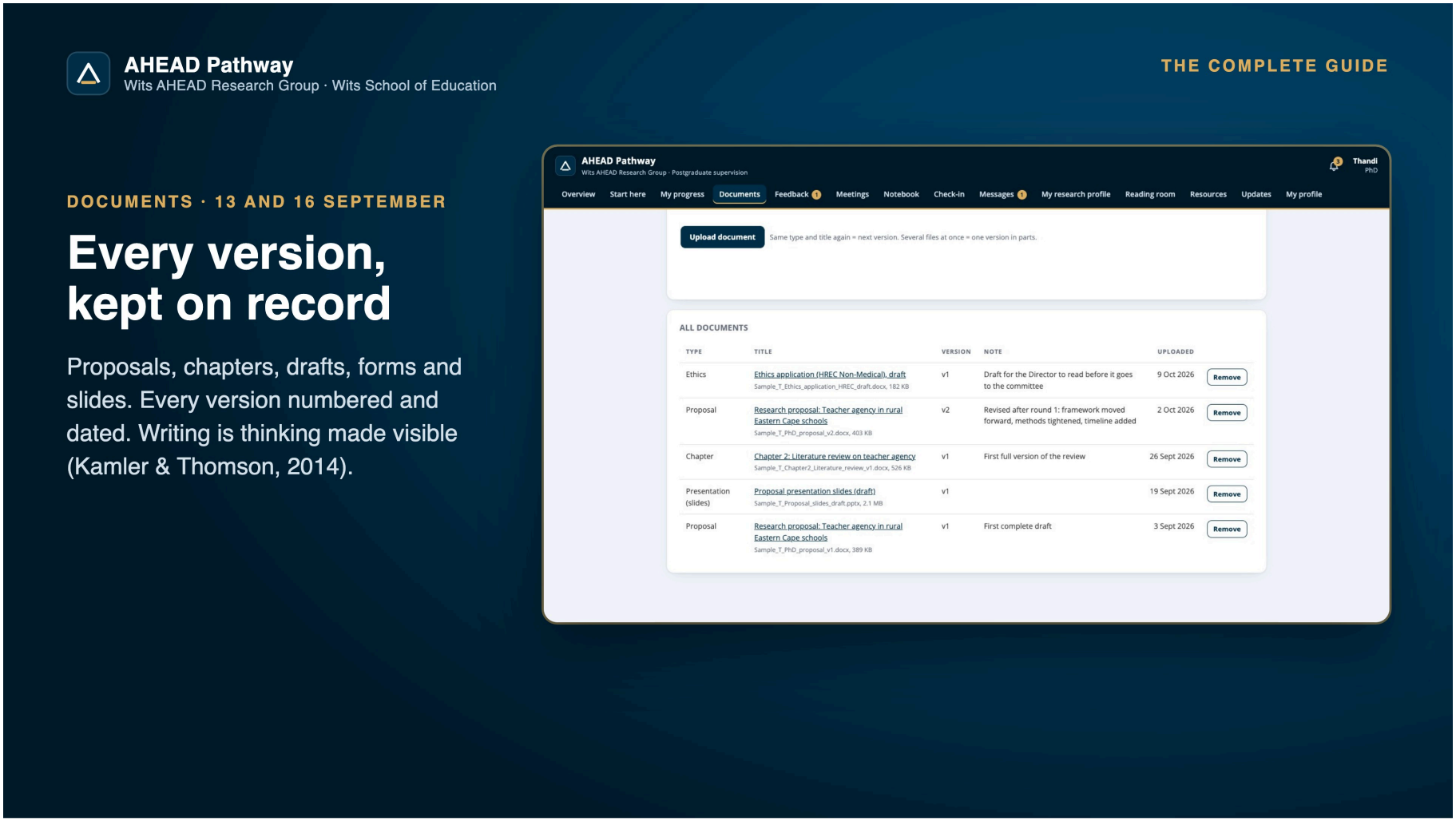
4 OF 33 Ground zero: the thirteenth of September 2026, when AHEAD Pathway opened. In its first four days came your record, your milestones and your documents, feedback on every draft, messages and notifications on your phone, and team workspaces for research projects. Here is what each part does.



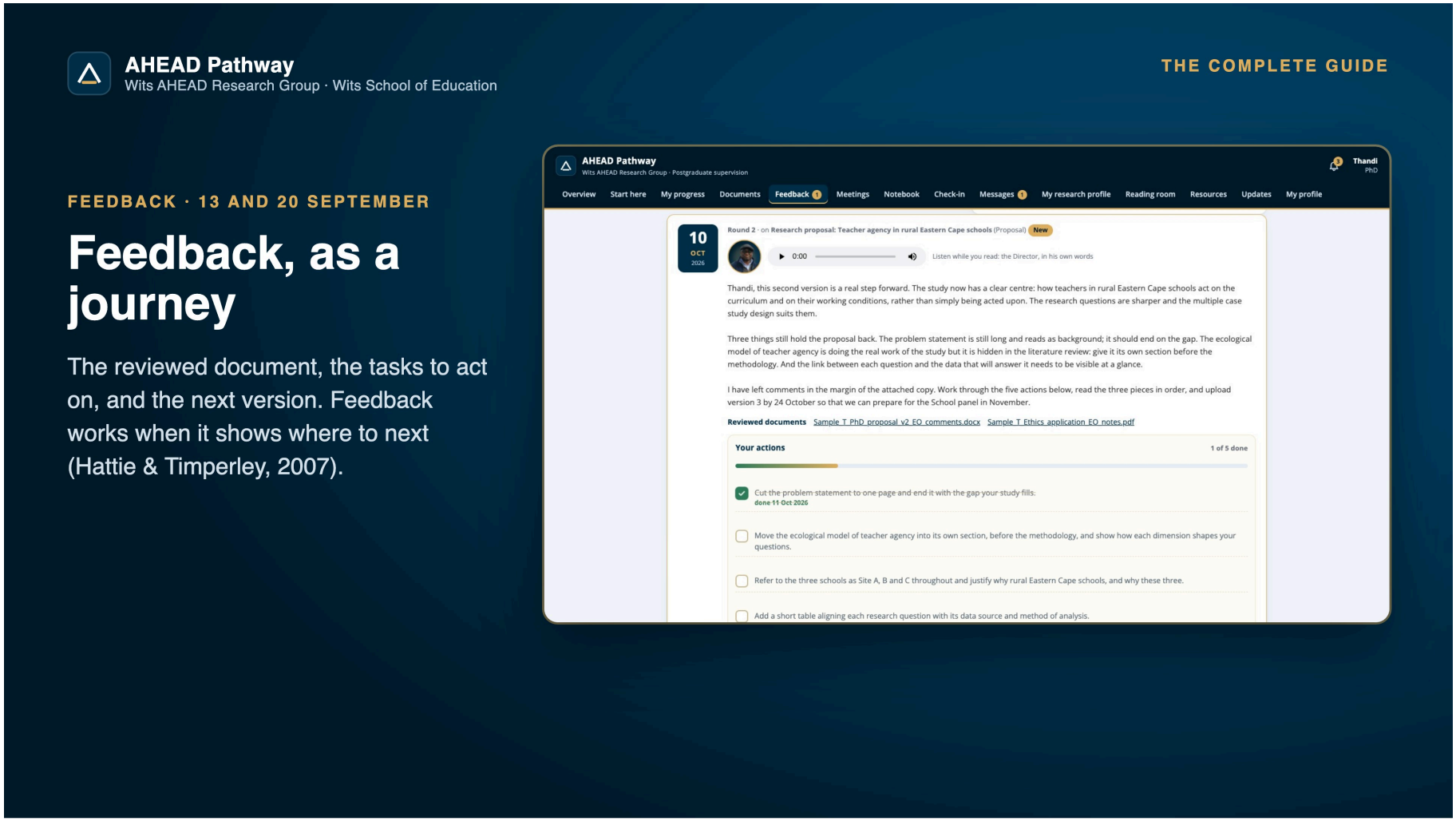
5 OF 33 Your Overview shows your degree at a glance: where you are, your next milestone, the latest feedback, and anything waiting for you. You sign in with your university email address and a one-time code, so there is no password to remember, and you can install Pathway on your phone like an app. The power: you always know where you stand.



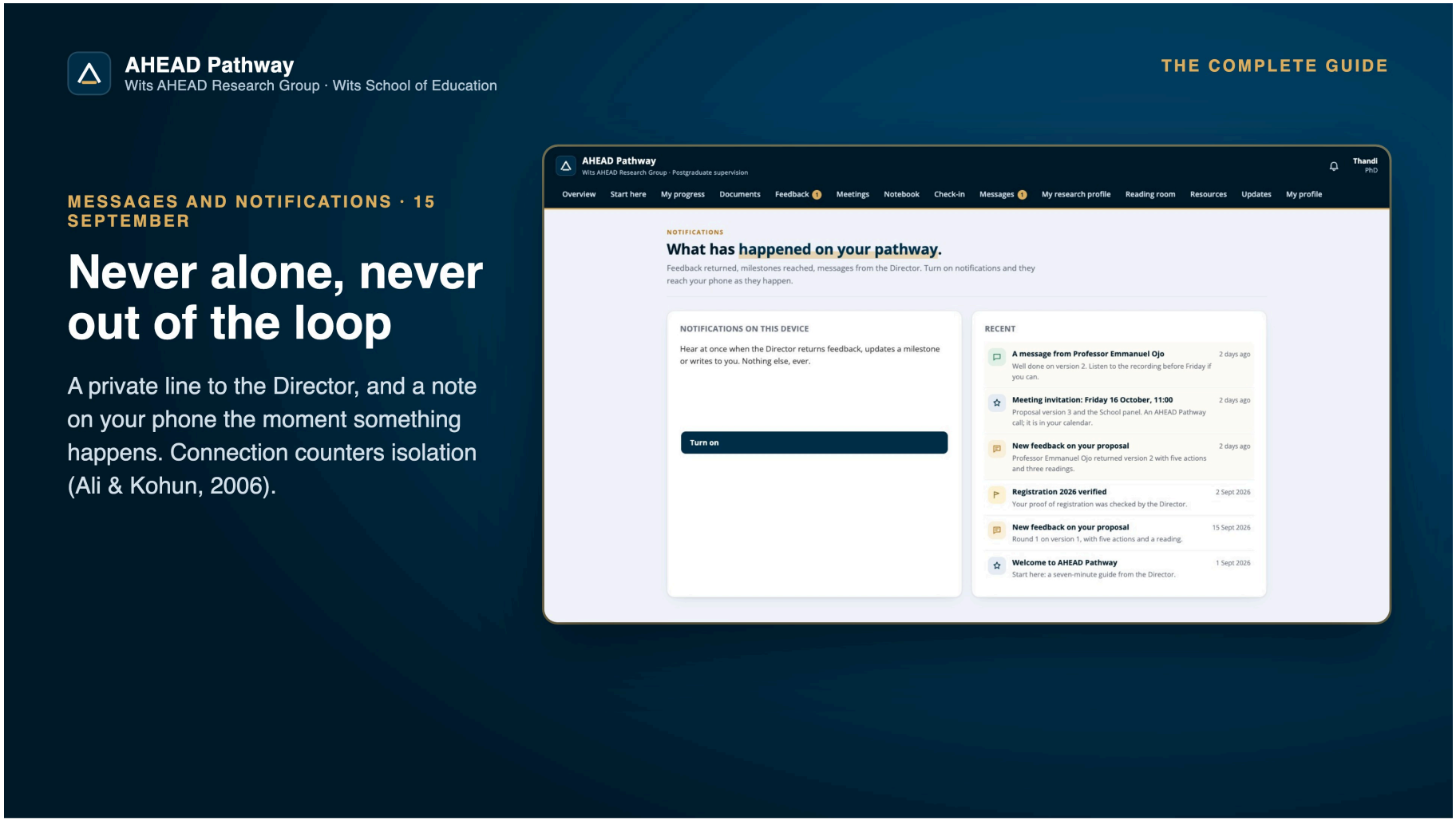
6 OF 33 My progress lays out every milestone of your degree, from registration and the proposal to ethics, the full draft, examination and graduation, with what is done, what is next, and a target date for each. Catherine Manathunga showed that the early warning signs of a degree in difficulty can be seen, and acted on, long before a deadline is missed. Your milestones make those signs visible, to you and to the Director.



7 OF 33 Documents is where your writing lives: your proposal, each chapter, full drafts, forms, and now your slides. Every version is numbered and dated, and nothing is ever lost. Barbara Kamler and Pat Thomson argue that writing is not what you do after the research: writing is how research thinking happens. Your versions, side by side, show your thinking growing.



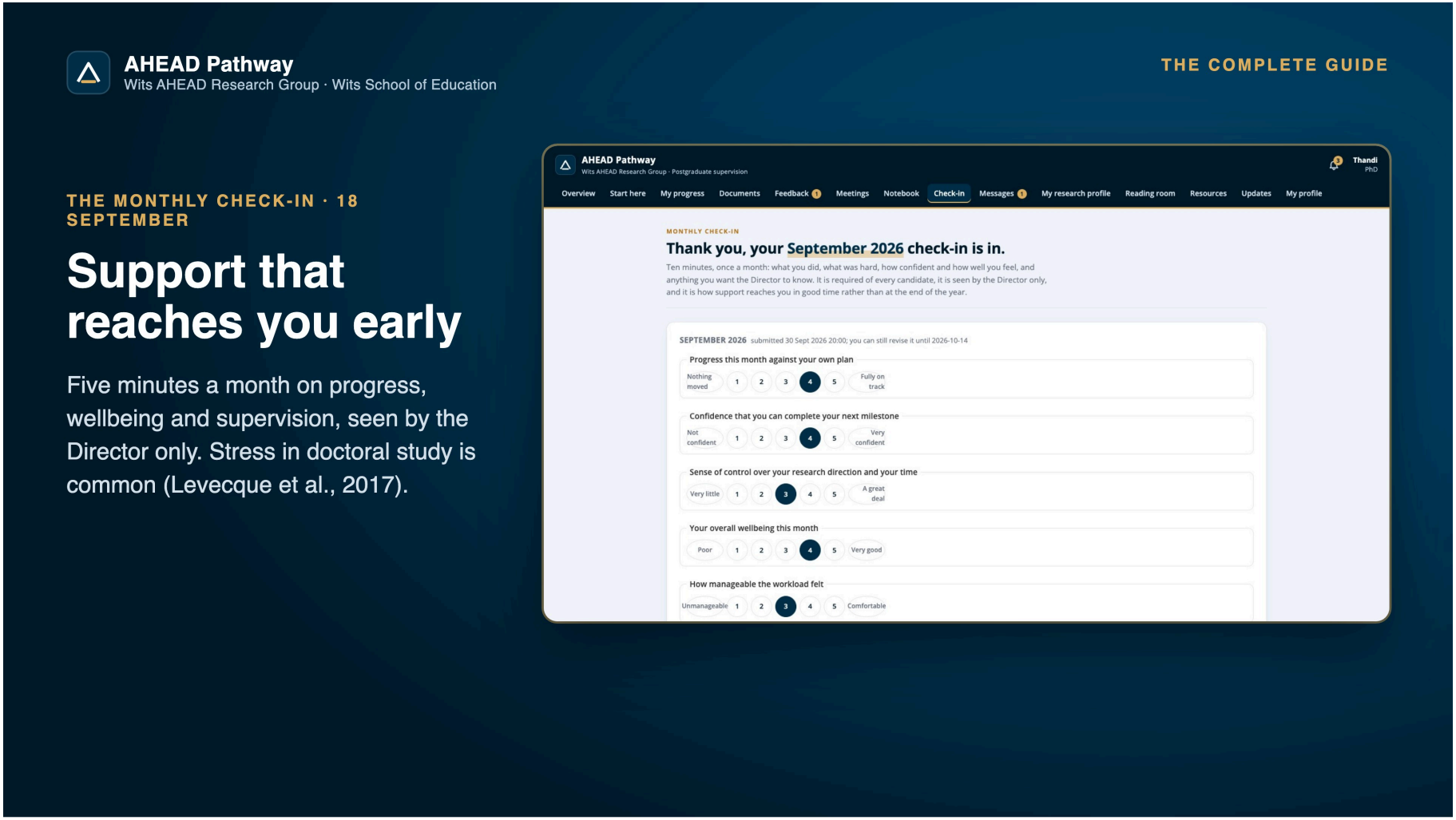
8 OF 33 Feedback arrives as a journey: the reviewed document, a clear list of tasks you tick off as you act on them, and the feedback read aloud if you wish. Hattie and Timperley showed that feedback is among the most powerful influences on learning, when it answers three questions: where am I going, how am I going, and where to next. Carless and Boud add that feedback only works when the student acts on it. Pathway is built so that every comment leads to an action, and every action to the next version.



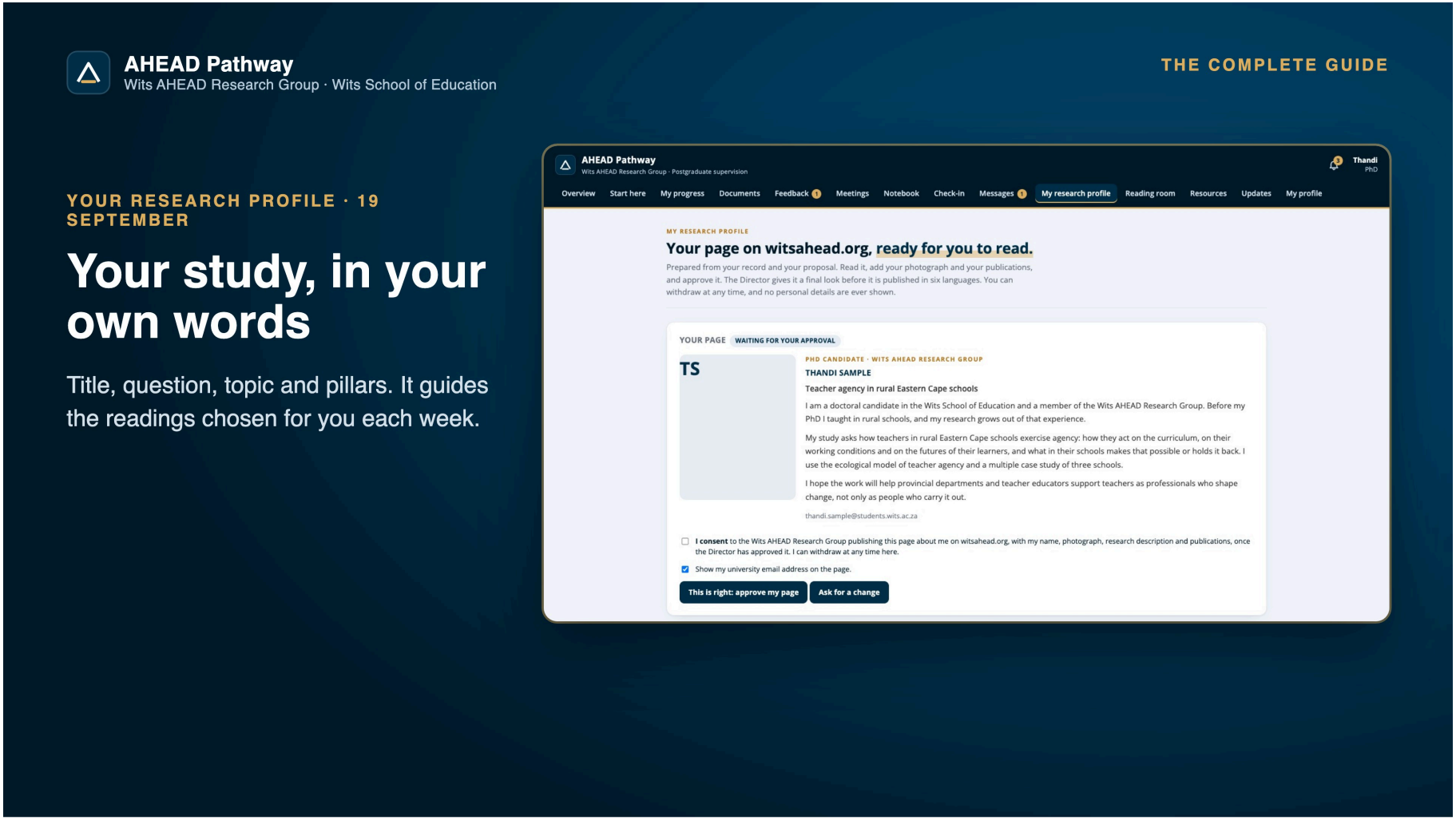
9 OF 33 From the fifteenth of September, Messages gave you a private line to the Director, and notifications reach your phone the moment something happens: new feedback, a message, a meeting. Isolation is one of the strongest reasons candidates leave. With Pathway, you are never more than a message away. Please turn notifications on. You may want to pause here and do it now.



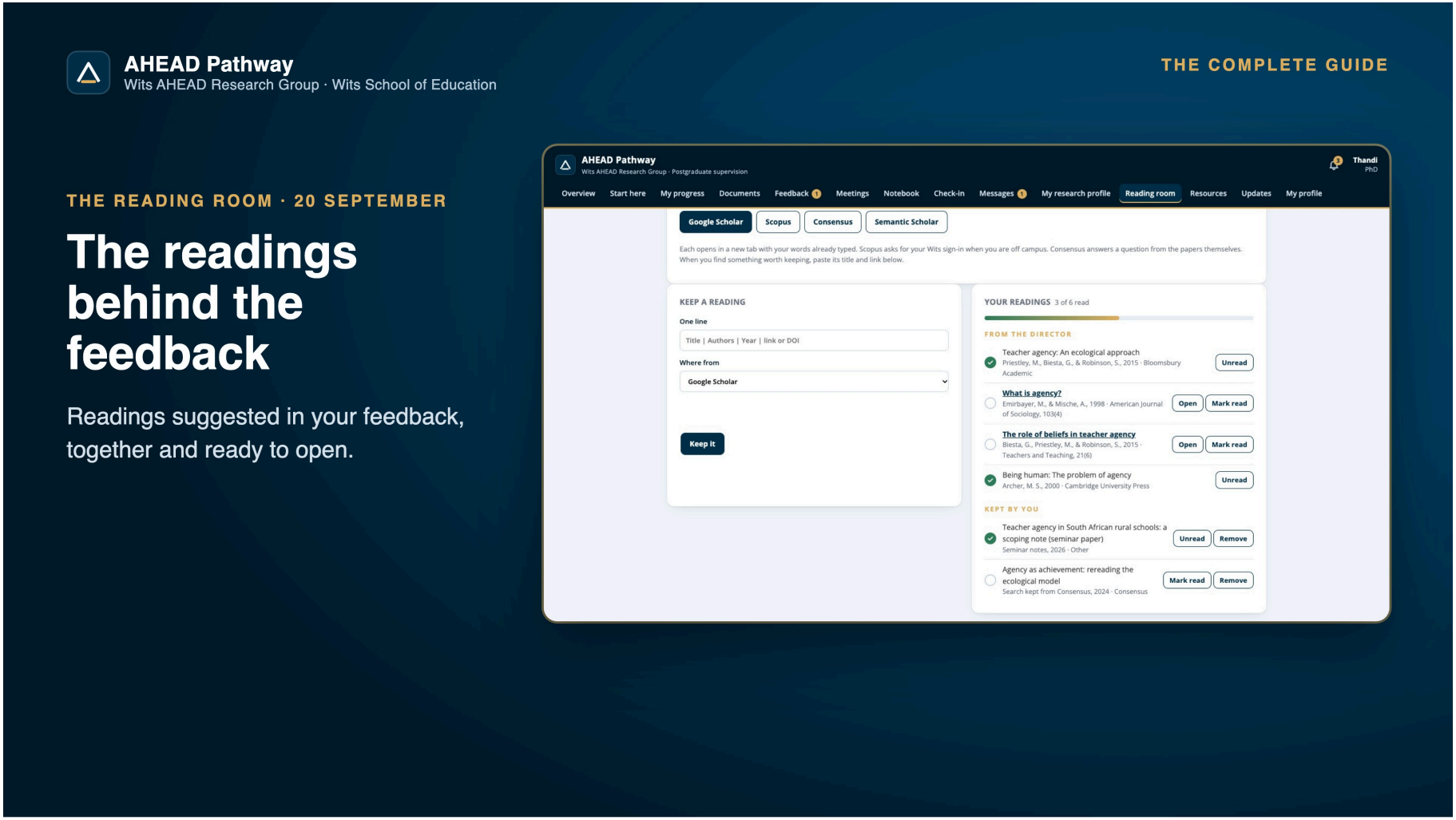
10 OF 33 Week two, from the eighteenth to the twenty-second of September, brought calls and a meetings calendar, the monthly check-in, your research profile, and the Reading room. Remember: you can stop the video at any point, try each part, and come back.



11 OF 33 The monthly check-in takes five minutes: your progress, your confidence, your agency, your wellbeing, your workload and your supervision, what you did, what was hard, and what you need. Only the Director sees it. Because stress in doctoral study is common, this is how support reaches you before small difficulties become large ones.



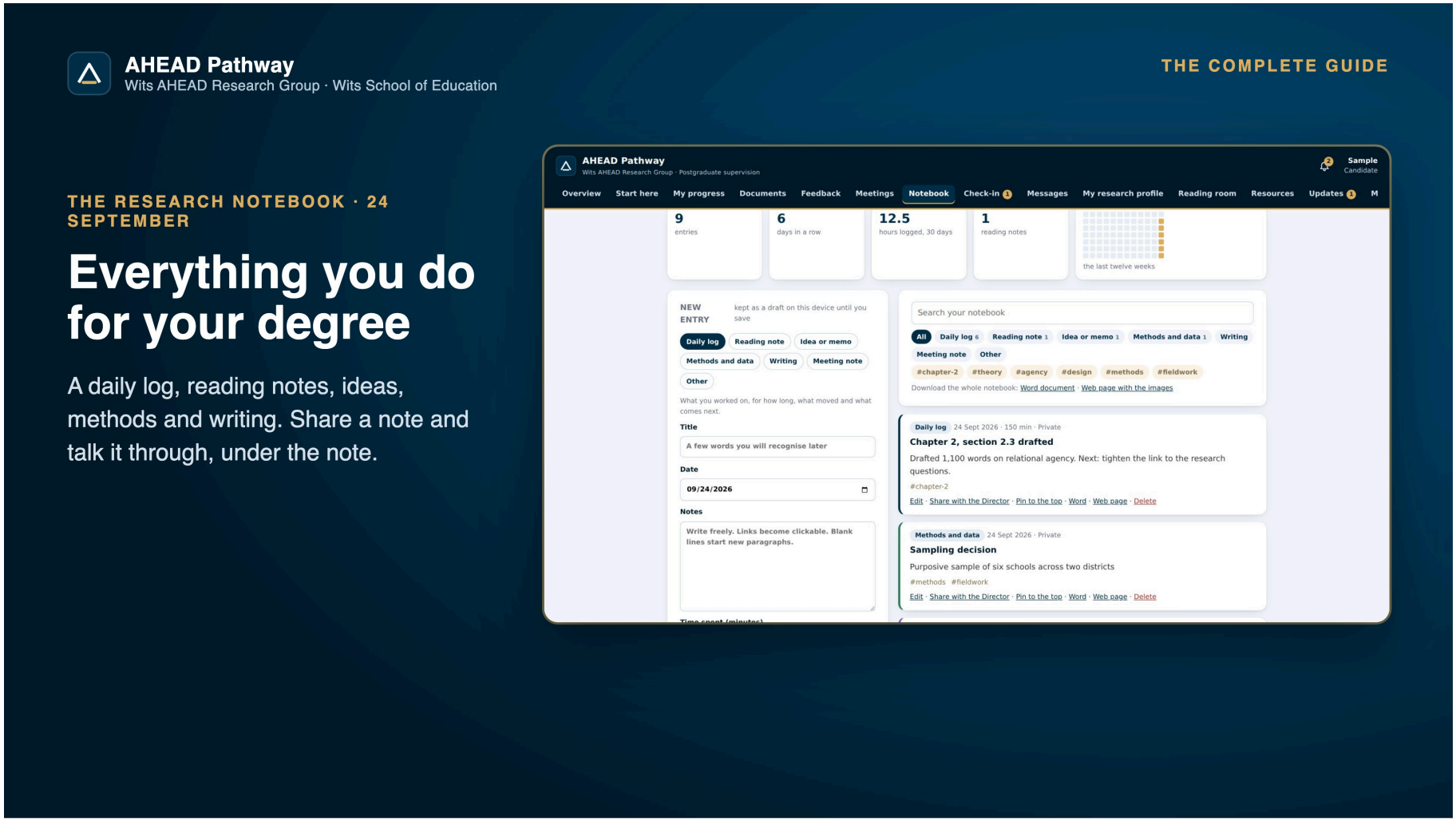
12 OF 33 Your research profile describes your study in your own words: your title, your research question, your topic, and the pillars of the group your work speaks to. Keep it current, because it guides the readings chosen for you every week.



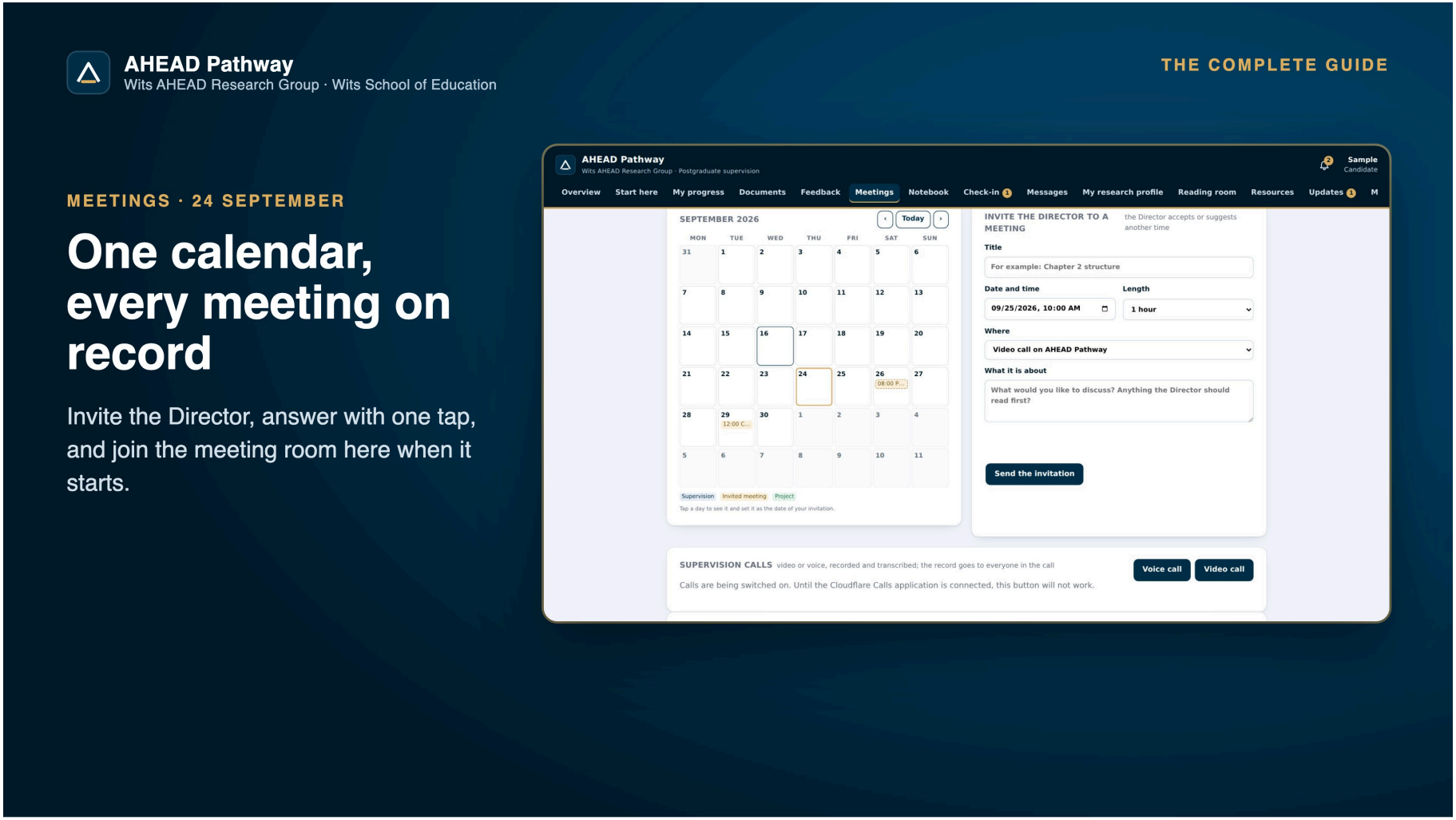
13 OF 33 The Reading room keeps together the readings suggested in your feedback, so that the scholarship behind each comment is always one click away.



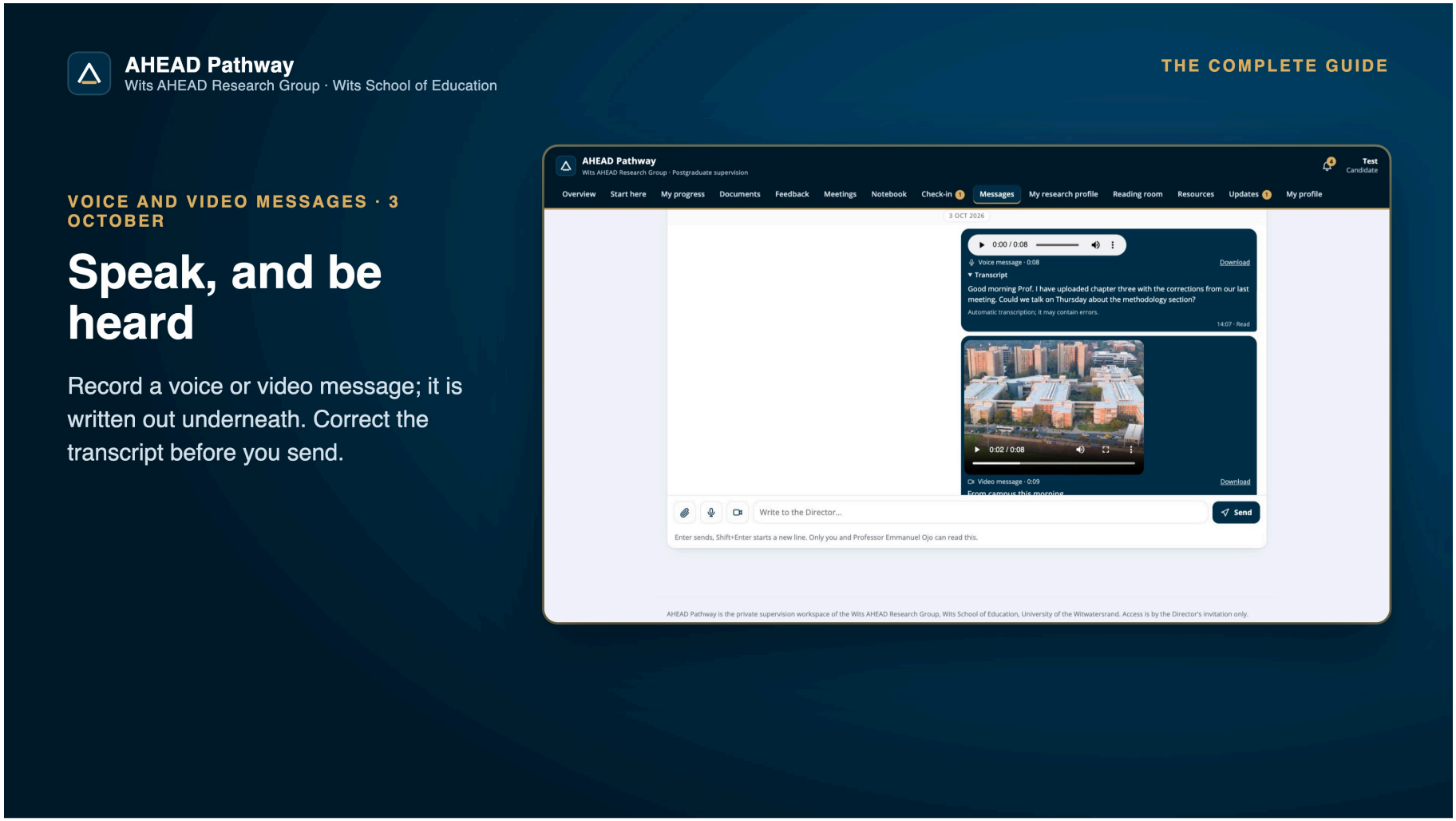
14 OF 33 Weeks three and four, from the twenty-fourth of September to the third of October, brought your research notebook and conversations under your notes, meeting invitations, your ideas for Pathway, voice and video messages, and every call kept in writing and as a recording.



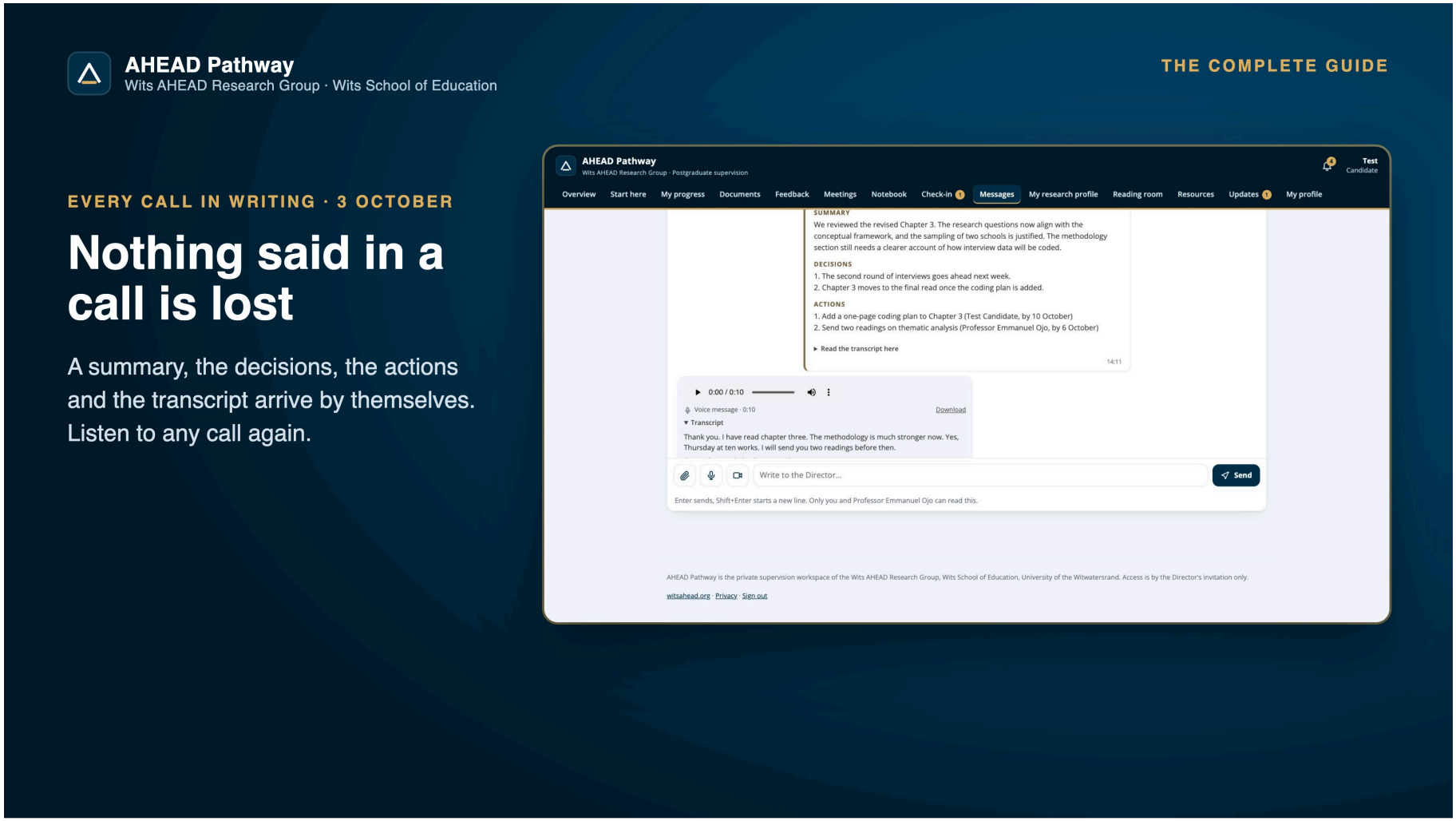
15 OF 33 The research notebook is yours alone: a daily log, notes on your readings, ideas, methods and writing, with photos of handwritten pages. From the first of October, sharing a note opens a conversation beneath it, so that you and the Director can talk your thinking through on the day it arises. Nick Hopwood describes doctoral agency as something built in relationships. The notebook is where that relationship lives between meetings.



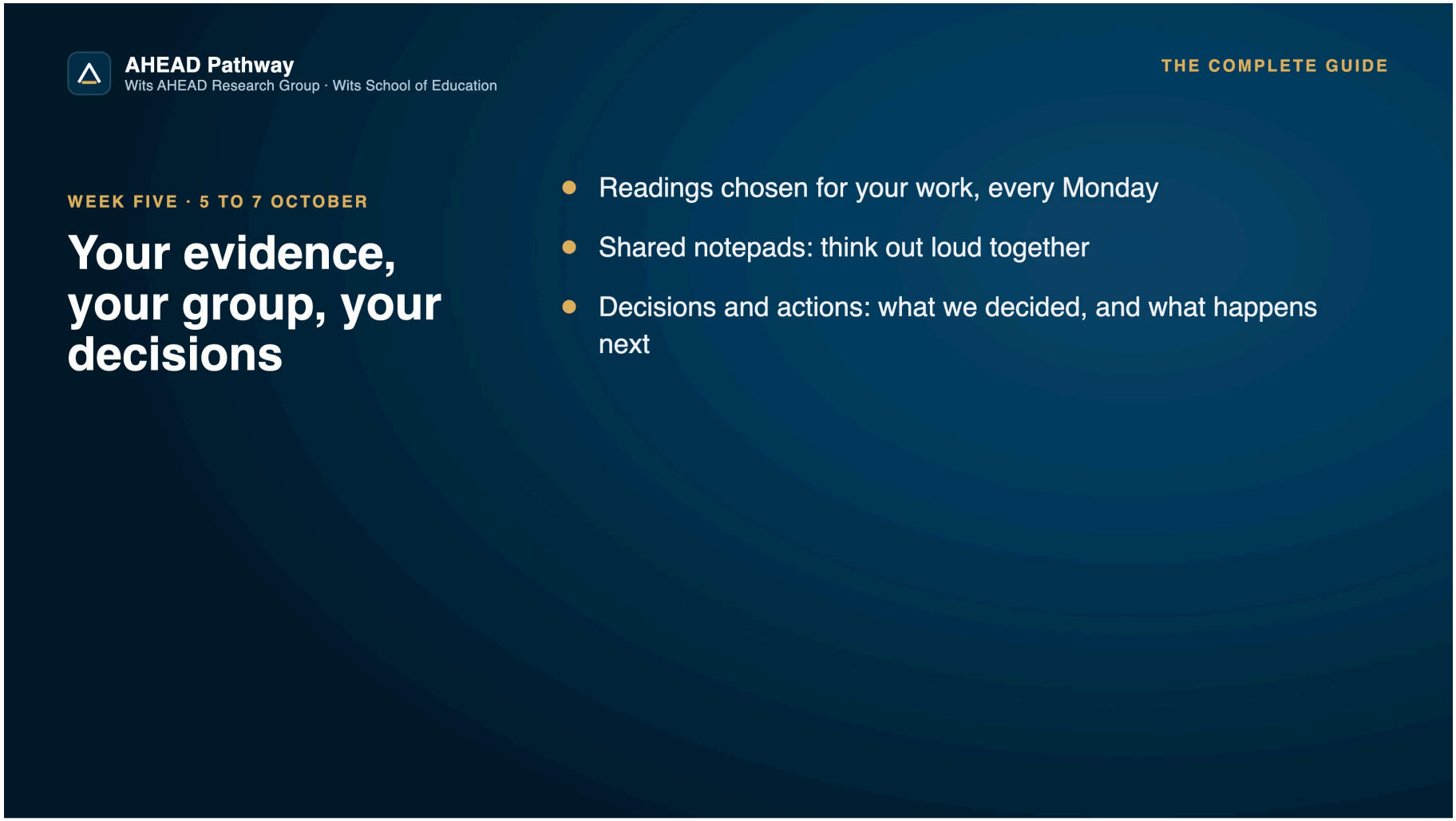
16 OF 33 Meetings became one calendar for everything: invite the Director, answer an invitation with one tap, and join the meeting room on Pathway when it starts, with a reminder shortly before.



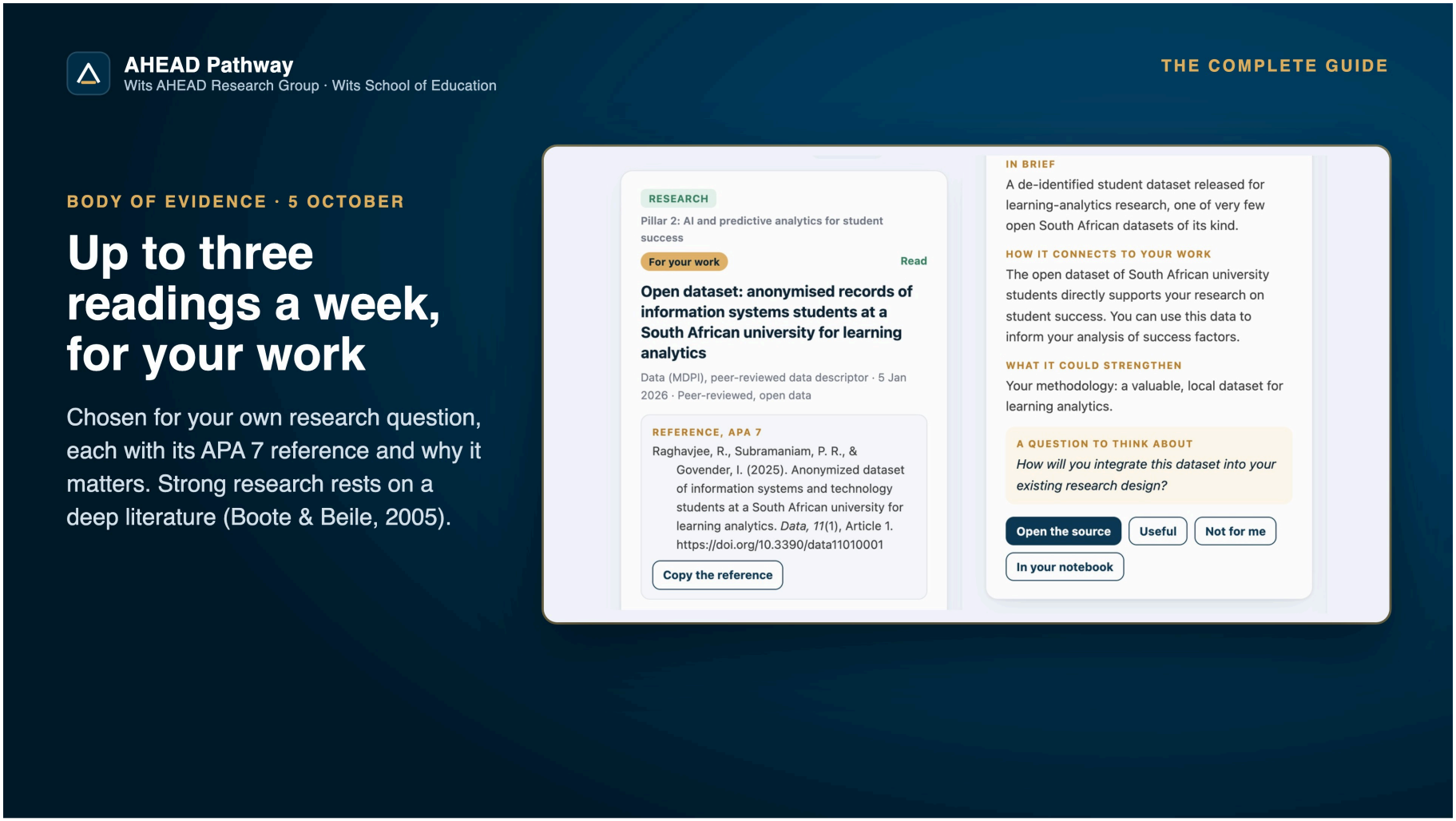
17 OF 33 On the third of October came voice and video messages. Tap the microphone and speak, or record a short video. Every message is written out underneath, and you can now correct the transcript before you send it. Sometimes the best thinking comes when you say it aloud.



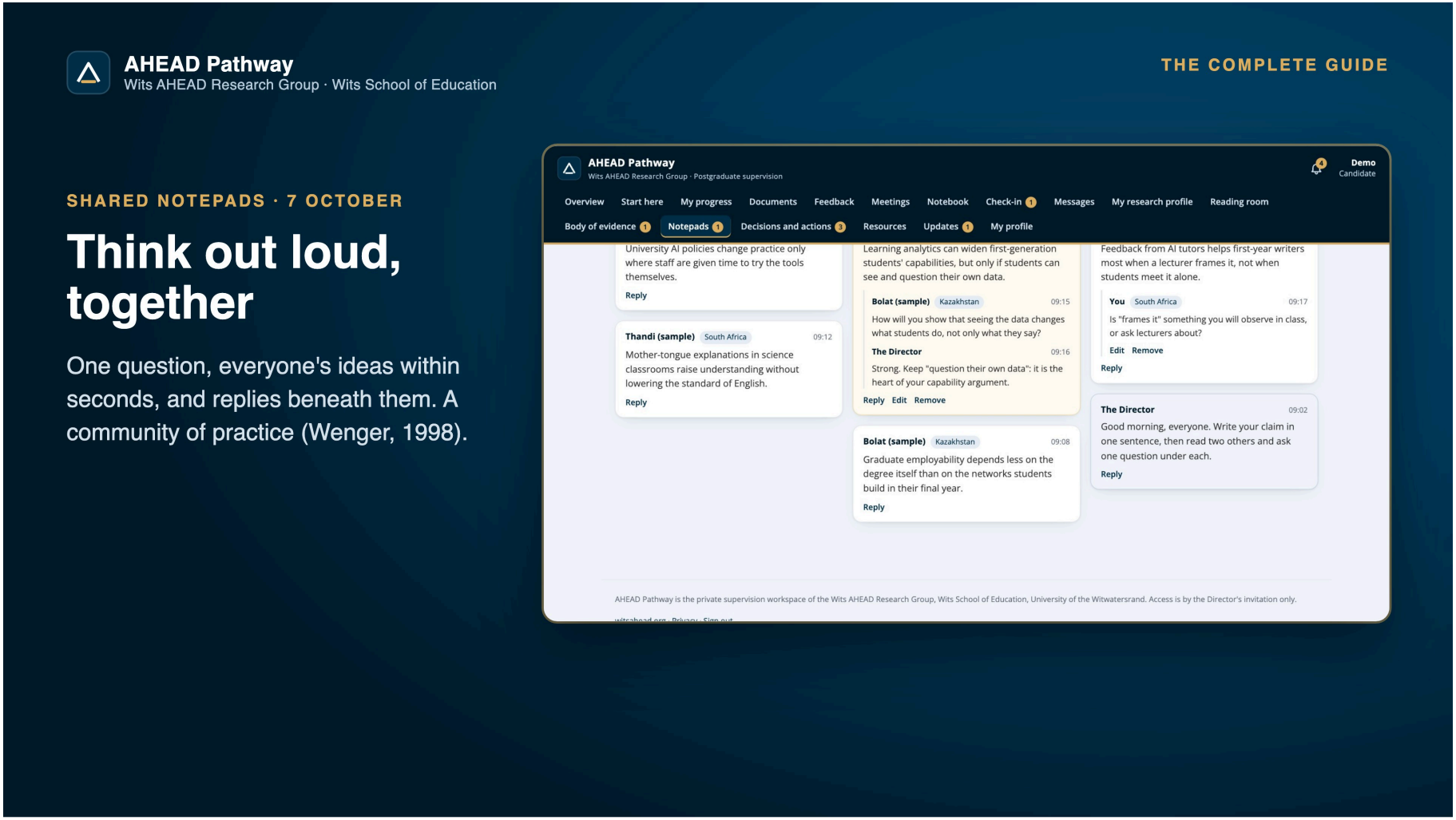
18 OF 33 From the same day, after every call the record arrives in your messages by itself: a summary, what we decided, the actions and who does them, and the full transcript. And you can listen to any call again. It is easy to remember a decision and lose the reasoning behind it. Now the reasoning stays with you.



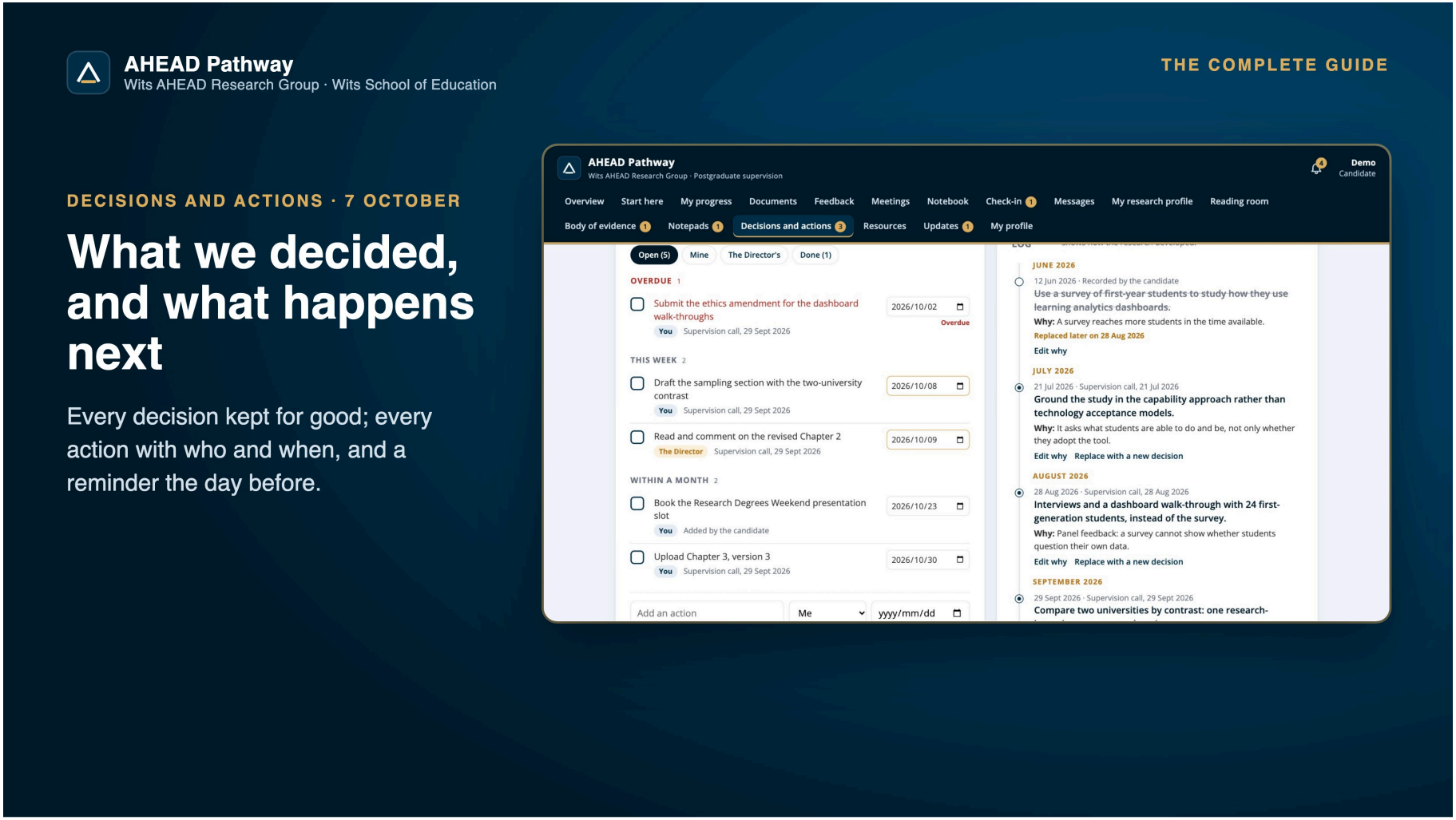
 Week five, from the fifth to the seventh of October, brought readings chosen for your work every Monday, shared notepads, and decisions and actions. Two of these began as your ideas.



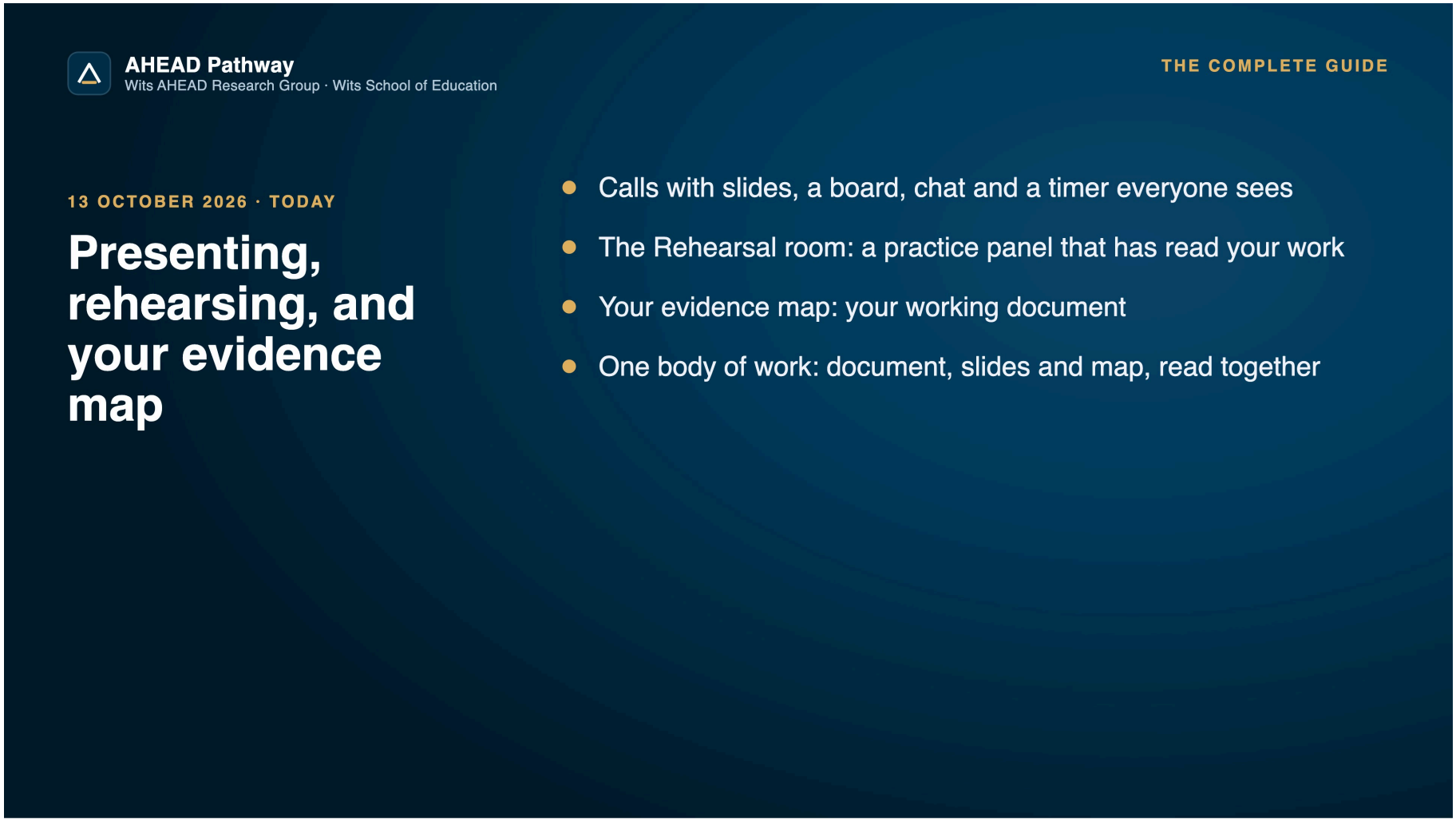
20 OF 33 Every Monday, your Body of evidence brings up to three readings chosen for your own research question, each with its reference in APA 7, a summary, how it connects to your work, and a question to think about. Boote and Beile argued that candidates must become scholars before they become researchers, with a deep command of the literature. A dozen well-chosen readings a month add up, over a year, to a real body of evidence.



21 OF 33 Shared notepads, suggested by one of you, let the whole group think out loud together: one question, everyone's ideas appearing within seconds, and replies beneath each one. Etienne Wenger showed that we learn most powerfully in communities of practice. The notepad makes our community visible.



22 OF 33 Decisions and actions, also suggested by one of you, keeps every research decision for good, and every action from our calls, meetings and feedback, with who does it and by when, and a reminder the day before. You confirm what was really agreed, in your own words. Over a degree, the decision log becomes the story of how your study developed, which is exactly what examiners ask about.



23 OF 33 And today, the thirteenth of October, brought five updates in a single day: calls built for presenting, the Rehearsal room, your evidence map, transcripts you can correct, and the Rehearsal room joined to your evidence. This is where everything comes together. If you watch only one chapter again, make it this one.

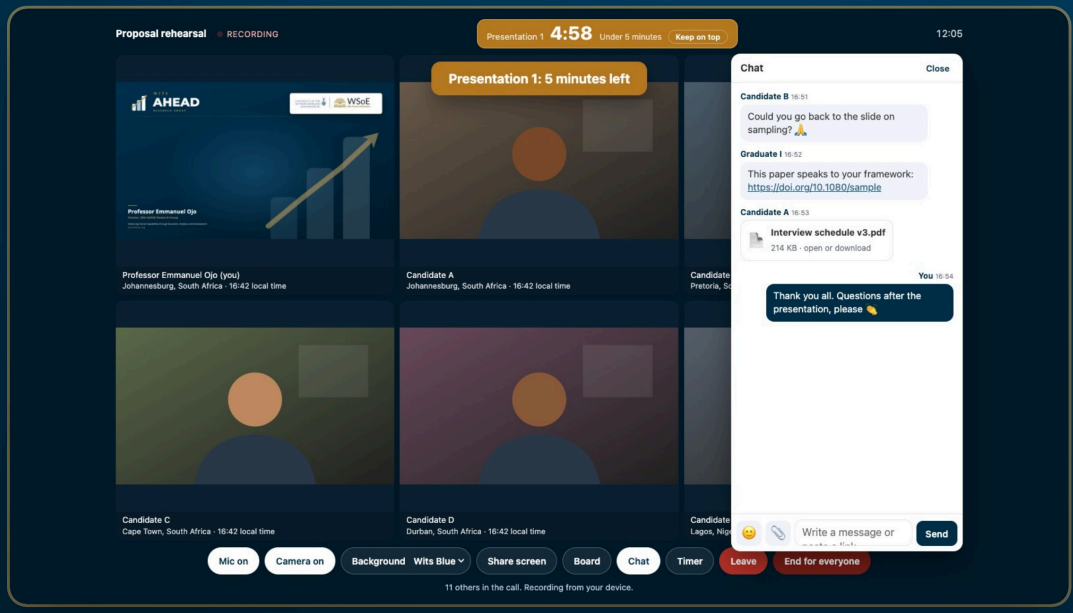
AHEAD Pathway
Wits AHEAD Research Group · Wits School of Education

THE COMPLETE GUIDE

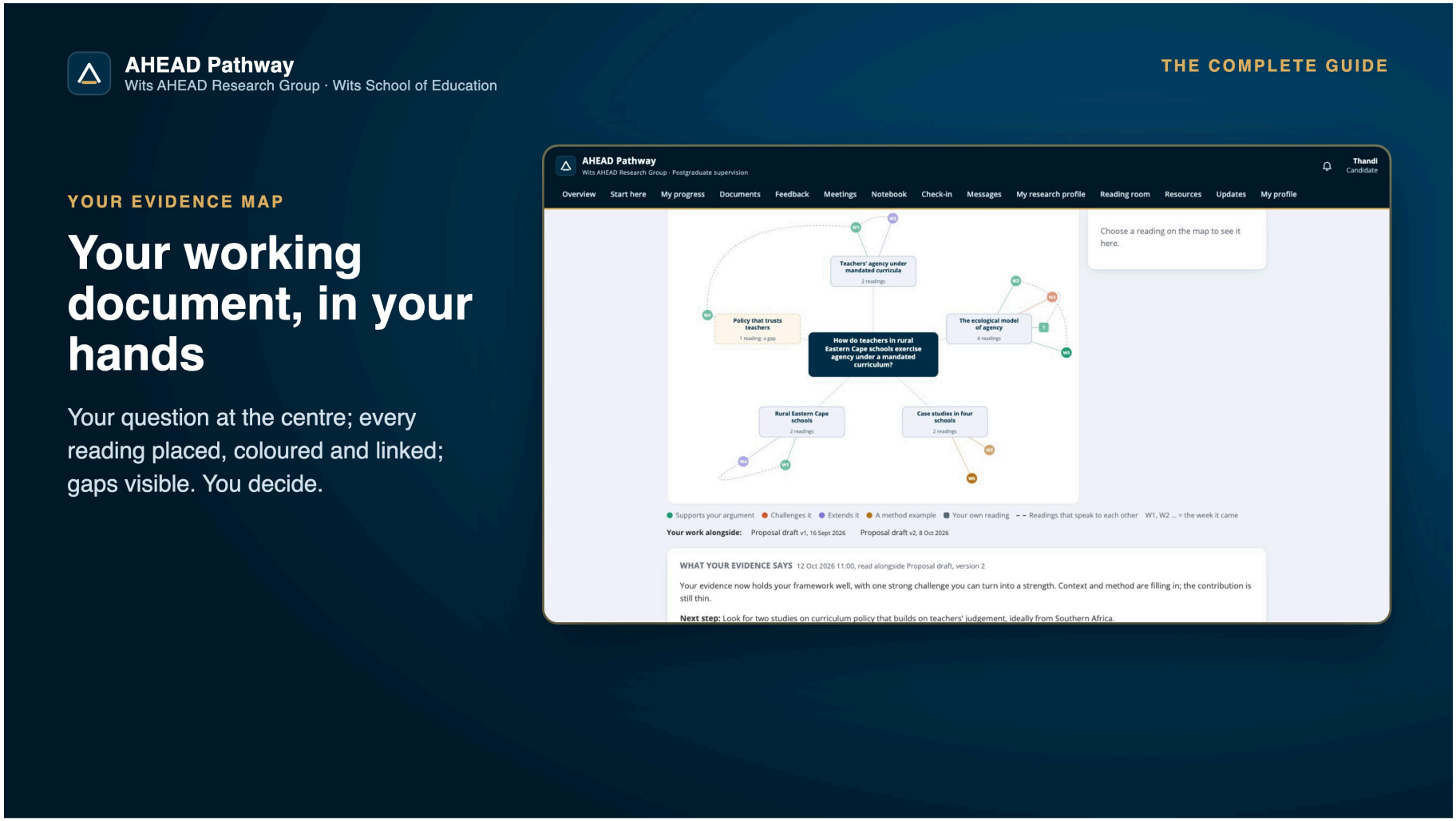
CALLS FOR PRESENTING

Everything a presentation needs

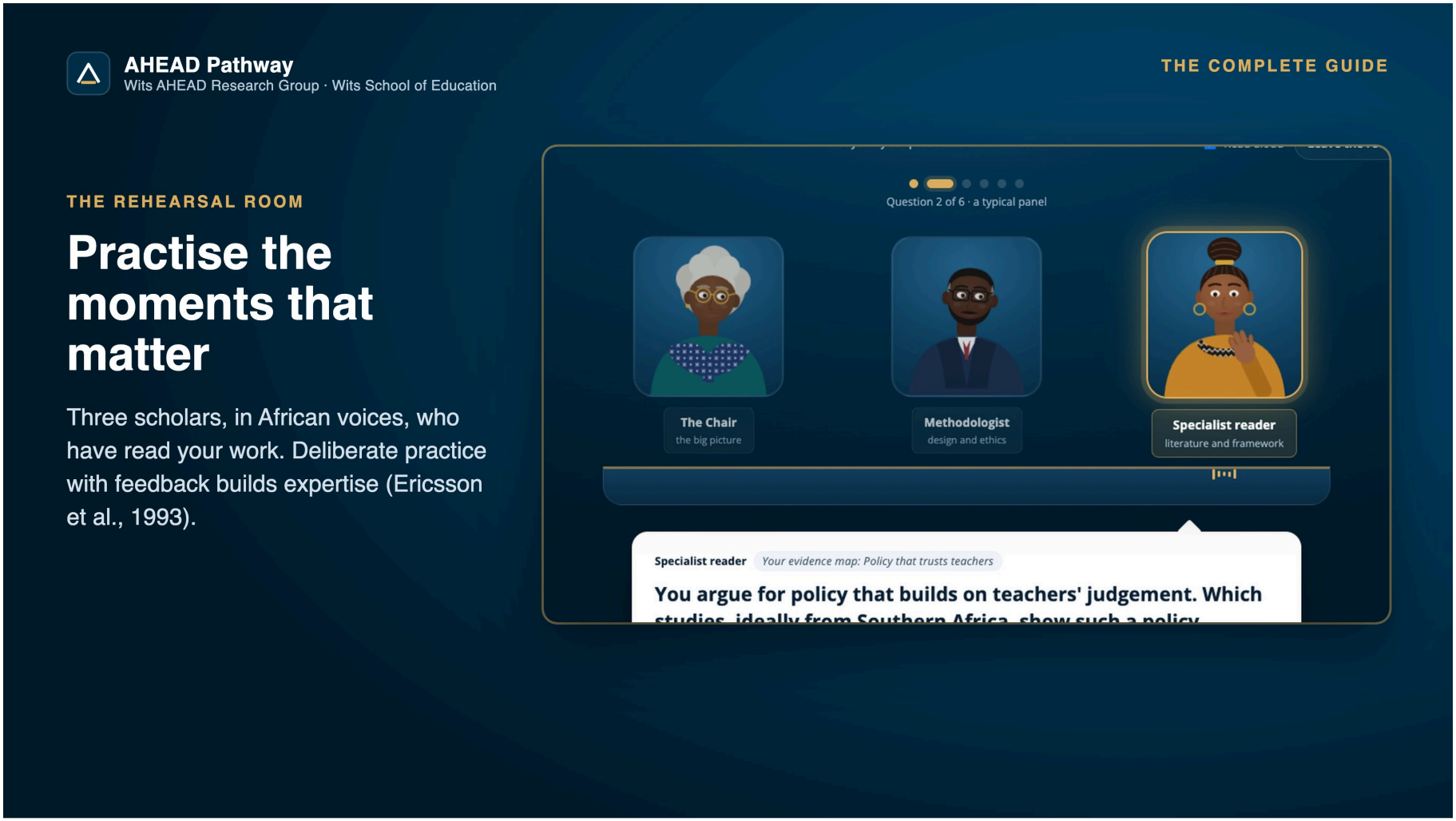
Share your slides, write on a board, chat with files and links, and keep to a timer that everyone sees.



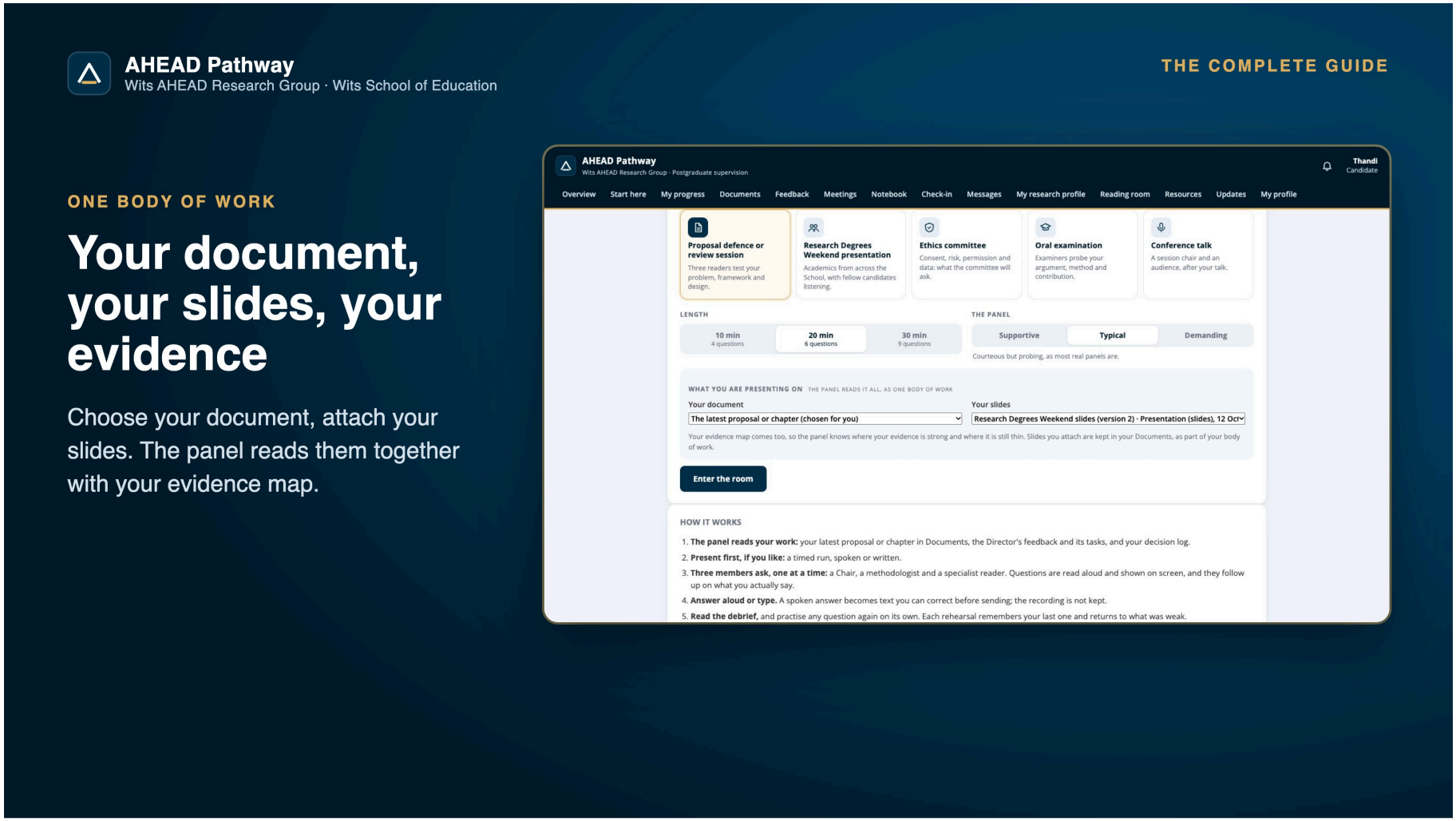
24 OF 33 Our calls now carry everything a presentation needs: share your slides, write on a board or over your slides, chat with links and documents, and keep to a timer that everyone sees, with warnings at five minutes and at two.



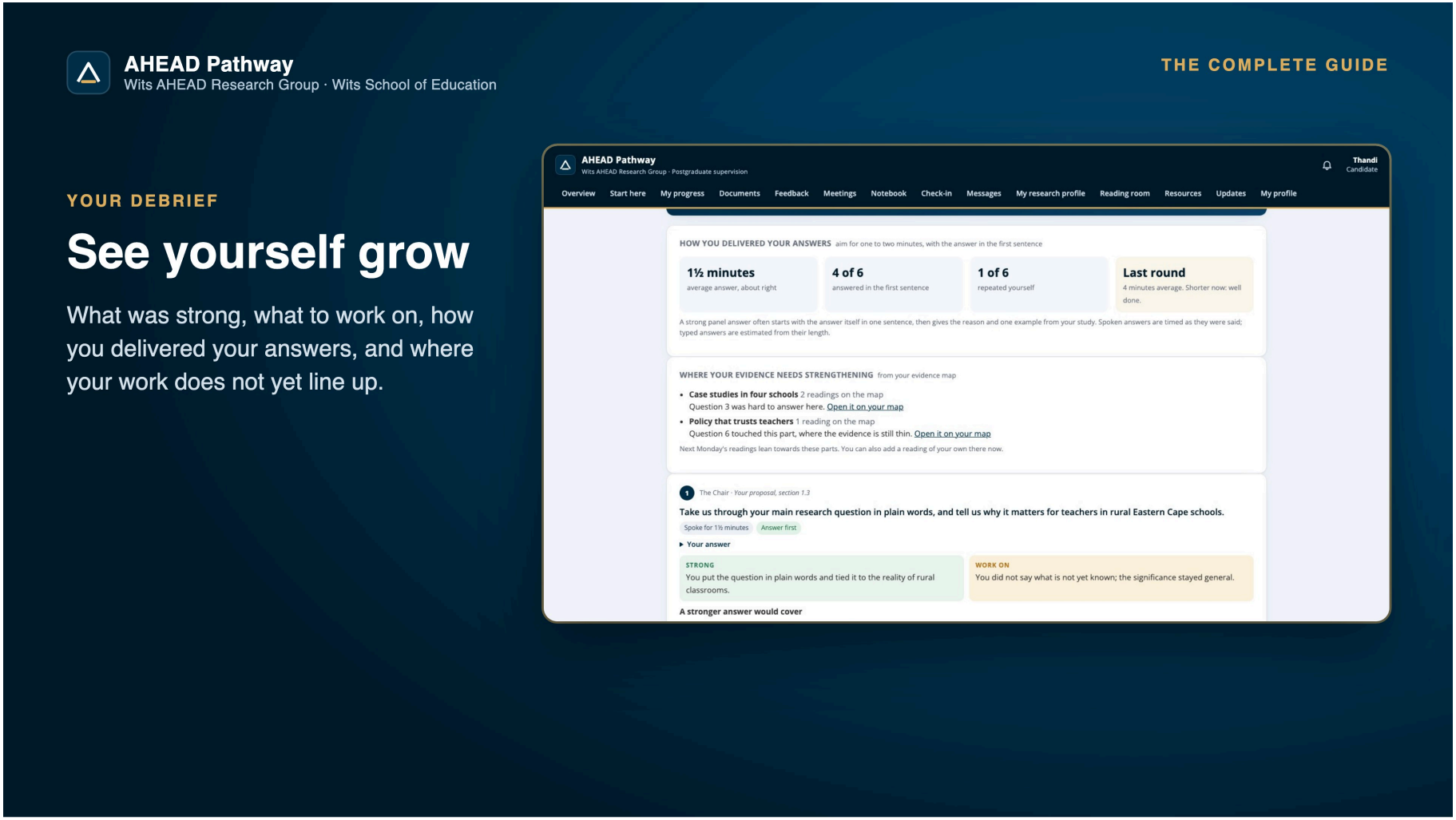
25 OF 33 Your evidence map puts your research question at the centre and every reading where it belongs, coloured by whether it supports, challenges or extends your argument, with the gaps visible. You decide where each reading goes, you write your notes, and you add your own readings. Each month it tells you what your evidence now says, read alongside your latest writing, and it all becomes one Word document, My evidence and thinking. It is synthesis, the heart of a literature review, made visible and kept alive.



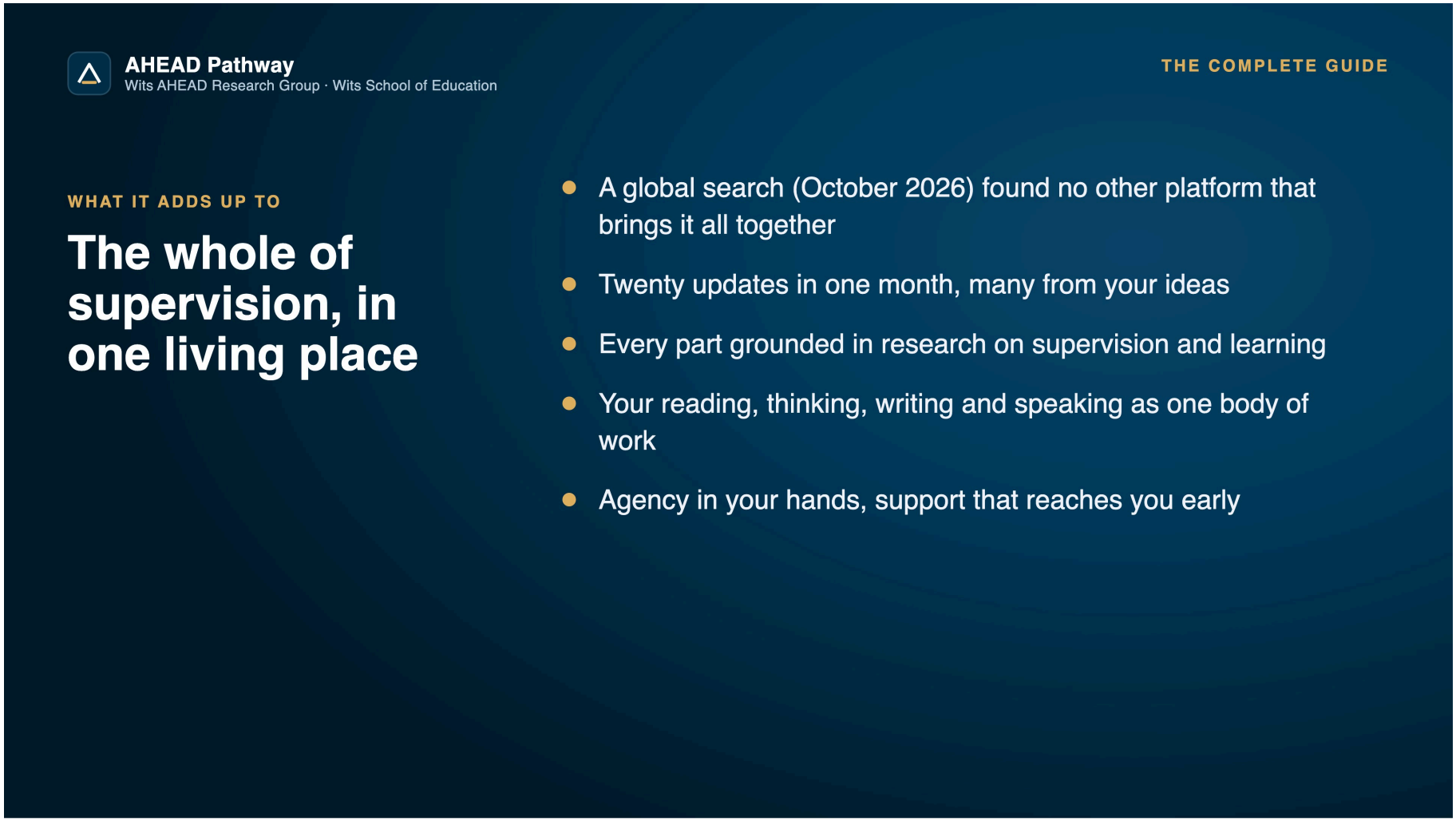
26 OF 33 The Rehearsal room is a practice panel that has read your own work: three African scholars, speaking in African voices, who ask one question at a time, follow up on what you say, nod and take notes as you answer, and confer before each question. Anders Ericsson showed that expertise grows through deliberate practice with immediate feedback, and Albert Bandura that confidence grows from mastery experiences. Every round is both.



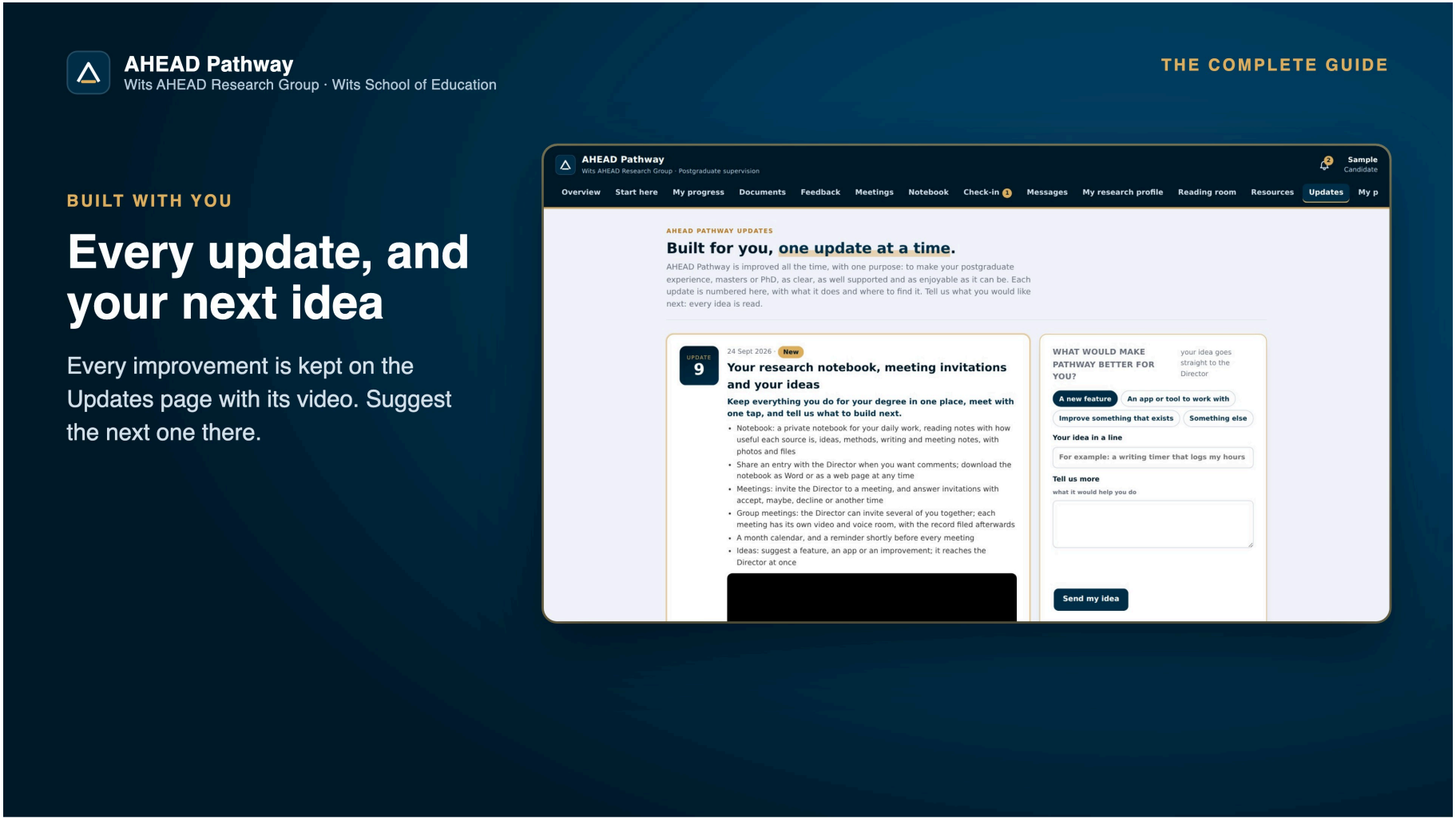
27 OF 33 Before you enter, choose the document you are presenting on and attach your slides. The panel reads your document, your slides and your evidence map together, as one body of work.



28 OF 33 Your debrief shows what was strong, what to work on, and how you delivered your answers, compared with your last round. It shows where your slides, your document and your evidence map do not yet line up, and links the questions you found hard to the parts of your map where your evidence is thin, so that what you found hard to say becomes what you read next. Reading, thinking, writing and speaking, in one loop.



29 OF 33 Step back and see what this adds up to. Twenty updates in a single month, many of them your ideas. Every part grounded in the research on supervision, feedback, practice and belonging. Your reading, your thinking, your writing and your speaking, brought together as one body of work. The agency in your hands, and support that reaches you early. In October 2026 we searched worldwide: university systems, commercial platforms, AI viva tools and literature tools. Many do one part well. We found no other platform, anywhere, that brings the whole of supervision together like this, and none whose practice panel prepares from your own supervision record and then shapes what you read next. That is the experience Professor Ojo has built for every one of his postgraduate students.



30 OF 33 Every update is kept on the Updates page, with its video and notes, so you can go back to any of them. Suggest the next improvement from the same page, and it comes straight to the Director. And come back to this guide whenever you like: watch it again, listen to it again, and you will see your own pathway more clearly each time.

THE RESEARCH BEHIND AHEAD PATHWAY

References (1 of 2)

- Ali & Kohun (2006) Int. J. Doctoral Studies 1
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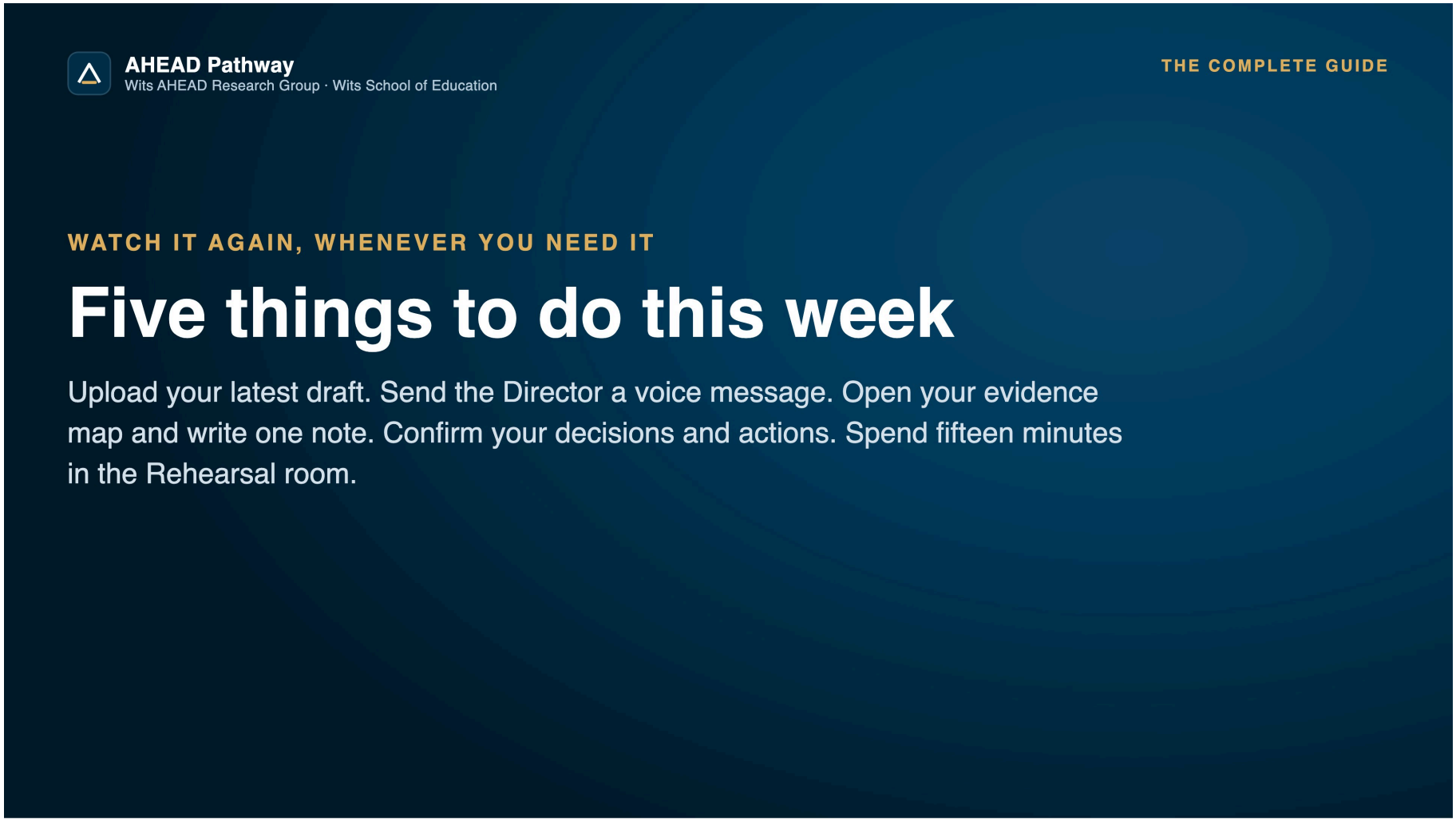
 These are the studies referred to in this guide.

THE RESEARCH BEHIND AHEAD PATHWAY

References (2 of 2)

- Hopwood (2010) Studies in Continuing Education 32(2)
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- Lee (2008) Studies in Higher Education 33(3)
- Lee, Zawacki-Richter & Cefa Sari (2024) Stud. Cont. Educ. 46(1)
- Levecque et al. (2017) Research Policy 46(4)
- Lovitts (2001) Leaving the Ivory Tower
- Manathunga (2005) Teaching in Higher Education 10(2)
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 The full references, with links, are in the written guide that comes with this video.



33 OF 33 Here are five things to do this week. Upload your latest draft. Send the Director a voice message about where your work is. Open your evidence map and write one note. Confirm your decisions and actions. And spend fifteen minutes in the Rehearsal room. Watch this guide again whenever you need it, and listen to it on the way to campus. AHEAD Pathway was built for one reason: to make your postgraduate experience, masters or PhD, as clear, as well supported and as powerful as it can be. That is AHEAD Pathway: your degree, well supported, every step of the way.

How we know: the global search of October 2026

In October 2026 we searched worldwide for anything that brings postgraduate supervision together as AHEAD Pathway does: university research-degree and supervision systems in Africa, Australia, Europe, North America and Asia; commercial and open platforms for thesis and PhD management; AI tools for viva, defence and presentation practice; literature-mapping tools; and the research literature on digital and online doctoral supervision.

Many tools do one part well: milestone and meeting records, thesis trackers with chat, AI mock vivas from an uploaded thesis, and citation maps. None we found combines more than about three of the parts of AHEAD Pathway, and we found nowhere else: calls inside a supervision platform that become decisions and actions the candidate confirms; a monthly check-in with an early-warning view inside a supervision platform; readings placed on a map of the candidate's own study whose gaps steer the next readings; and a practice panel prepared from the candidate's own supervision record whose weak answers shape what they read next. Reviews of online doctoral supervision find candidates patching together separate tools, mostly for communication (Gray & Crosta, 2019; Lee et al., 2024).

Our conclusion: we have searched widely and found no other platform, anywhere, that brings the whole of postgraduate supervision together in one place as AHEAD Pathway does. The search covered what is public and in English; university systems that are not public could not be examined, and new tools appear often, so we will repeat it.

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